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Test – 26

Economics

Topics covered:

- Agriculture
- infrastructure and manufacturing
- Industry
- Services sector
- Current Affairs August & September 2021



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DEDICATED PRELIM PROGRAM(DPP)

UPSC-CSE PRELIMINARY TEST SERIES – 2021/2022

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TEST BOOKLET SERIES

Test Code:

DPP

**TEST BOOKLET
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST - 26**

E 26

Time Allowed: Two Hours

Maximum Marks : 200

INSTRUCTIONS

1. IMMEDIATELY AFTER THE COMMENCEMENT OF THE EXAMINATION, YOU SHOULD CHECK THAT THIS TEST BOOKLET DOES NOT HAVE ANY UNPRINTED OR TORN OR MISSING PAGES OR ITEMS, ETC.

2. ENCODE CLEARLY THE TEST BOOKLET SERIES CODE A, B, C OR D AS THE CASE MAY BE IN THE APPROPRIATE PLACE IN THE ANSWER SHEET.

3. You have to enter your Roll Number on the Test Booklet in the provided alongside this line. DO NOT write anything else on the Test Booklet.

4. This Test Booklet contains 100 questions. Each question is printed in English. Each item comprises four responses (answers). You will select the response which you want to mark on the Answer Sheet. In case you feel that there is more than one correct response, mark the response which you consider the best. In any case, choose ONLY ONE response for each item.

5. All items carry equal marks.

6. Penalty for wrong answers:

THERE WILL BE PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS MARKED BY A CANDIDATE IN THE OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTION PAPERS.

- I. There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, One-Third of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
- II. If a candidate gives more than one answer, it will be treated as a wrong answer even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above to that question.
- III. If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no penalty for that question.

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TOPICS COVERD: Agriculture, infrastructure and manufacturing, Industry, Services sector, Current Affairs August to September 2021



Q.1) Which of the following are components of the Institutional Factors in agriculture?

1. Land Holdings.
2. Computerisation of Land Records.
3. Agricultural Credit.
4. Seeds.
5. Abolition of Intermediaries.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1, 2 and 5
- b) 2, 3, 4 and 5
- c) 1, 2, 3 and 5
- d) 3, 4 and 5

Q.2) With reference to the Cropping Pattern, consider the following statements:

1. Temperature has a great bearing on the cropping pattern of an area.
2. Monocropping creates conditions for the spread of pests and diseases in plants.
3. The income maximisation aspect plays an important role in influencing the cropping pattern in the country.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) None of the above.

Q.3) Consider the following statements about the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund:

1. Agriculture Infrastructure Fund is a centrally sponsored scheme.
2. Rs. 1 Lakh Crore will be provided by banks and financial institutions as loans to eligible beneficiaries.
3. The eligible beneficiaries are Farmers, FPOs, Cooperative Societies, SHGs and Joint Liability Groups.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

1. 1 and 2 only
2. 2 and 3 only
3. 1 and 3 only
4. All of the above.

Q.4) Consider the following statements:

1. The Sahakar Mitra Scheme was launched by the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises for online Placement of Trainees for helping

employers to post job openings, & facilitating candidates to apply.

2. Bhavantar Bhugtaan Yojana of Odisha sought to provide relief to farmers by providing the differential between MSPs and market prices.
3. Adopting no-tillage in agro-ecosystems enhances carbon (C) sequestration in soils.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 2 only

Q.5) Consider the following statements about Krishi Megh:

1. It is a weather forecasting tool of the Indian Meteorological Department.
2. It is developed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.
3. It is funded completely by the World Bank.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.6) With reference to Pulses, consider the following statements:

1. Pulses help in the Nitrogen fixation in the soil.
2. Bihar is the leading producer of Pulses in India.
3. Pulse crops are grown only during the kharif season in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 2 only

Q.7) Consider the following statements:

1. No Union Territory has yet achieved the status of 100% organic region.
2. Organic farmers do not use any kinds of fertilizers
3. "India Organic" is a certification mark for organically farmed food products manufactured in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.8) With reference to APEDA, Consider the following statements:

1. APEDA is mandated with the responsibility of export promotion and development of Fruits, vegetables, Meat, Pickles, Guar Gum and Dairy Products.
2. It is a statutory body under the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare.
3. It has been entrusted with the responsibility to monitor import of sugar.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 only

Q.9) In the context of Minimum Support Prices, consider the following statements:

1. Inter-crop price parity and International price situation are taken into consideration while determining MSP's.
2. MSP falls under the Amber Box Category of WTO.
3. MSP is defined as the Price at which the FCI sells the food grain for PDS consumption.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) None of the above.

Q.10) Consider the following Pairs:

Type of Agriculture	Features
1. Primitive Subsistence Farming	Depends upon monsoon and natural fertility of the soil.
2. Mixed farming	Rearing of animals and cultivation of crops together
3. Intensive Farming	Uses higher inputs to increase the overall yield.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.11) In the context of Plantation Agriculture, consider the following:

1. Plantation agriculture is a type of commercial farming.

2. Only food crops are grown in Plantation Agriculture.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.12) With reference to the Operation Green, consider the following statements:

1. It focuses on organized marketing of Tomatoes, Onions and Potatoes by connecting farmers with consumers.
2. It has an outlay of Rs.50000 crores.
3. NAFED will be the Nodal Agency to implement price stabilisation measures.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.13) Consider the following statements about the Essential Commodities Act:

1. This Act comes under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs.
2. This Act regulates only the supply and distribution of commodities but not their production.
3. Fertilisers are included in the Essential Commodities Act.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.14) What is/are the advantage/advantages of leaving crop residues on the field itself ?

1. It helps in the controlling of runoff and erosion in the fields.
2. It improves infiltration and aeration within the soil profile.
3. It increases the levels of particulate matter in the air.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.15) Consider the following statements:

1. Jute is primarily grown in West Bengal, Odisha and Assam and Andhra Pradesh.
2. Cold desert areas of India such as Lahaul and Spiti, Ladakh are suitable for cultivation of Asafoetida.
3. Tea grows well in stagnant soil as it enhances the water availability to the roots.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 2 only

Q.16) With reference to the Soil Health Card Scheme, consider the following statements:

1. Soil Health Card contains nutrient status of soil with respect to all nutrients except iron.
2. It is provided to all farmers in the country.
3. It provides two sets of fertilizer recommendations for all crops.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.17) Consider the following statements about the methods of growing rice:

1. Direct seeded crops tend to mature faster than transplanted crops.
2. Transplanting ensures a uniform plant stand and gives the rice crop a head start over emerging weeds.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.18) Consider the following statements:

1. CRISPR and intragenesis are tools available for precise and faster genetic modifications of plants.
2. Bt cotton is the only genetically modified crop that has been approved for commercial cultivation by the Government of India.
3. Unlike DNA editing, the effects of RNA editing are reversible.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only

- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.19) Consider the following statements about Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Act:

1. Farmers are entitled to sell even branded seed of a variety protected under this Act.
2. India enacted Plant Varieties and Farmers Rights Act, 2001 to give effect to the TRIPS agreement.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.20) With respect to Natural Farming and Organic Farming, consider the following statements:

1. No external fertilizers are added to soil or given to plantain Natural Farming, unlike Organic Farming.
2. Organic Farming is more expensive than Natural Farming.
3. Vermicomposting is an essential component of Natural Farming, unlike Organic Farming.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.21) Consider the following statements about SAMPADA Scheme:

1. It is aimed at modernising fishing infrastructure and quality control.
2. It is under the Ministry of Food Processing & Industries.
3. Mega Food Parks are essential components of the Scheme.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.22) With reference to Agriculture in India, consider the following statements:

1. Jhumming is practised in Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram.
2. In states like West Bengal and Odisha, three crops of paddy are grown in a year.
3. Madhuban Gajar variety is rich in high beta carotene and iron content.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.23) In the context of Agricultural Exports, consider the following statements:

1. NABARD is the central nodal agency for undertaking price support operations for pulses and oilseeds.
2. India is the world's biggest rice exporter.
3. India's agricultural exports crossed \$100 billion for the first time in 2020-21.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 2 only

Q.24) With reference to Agricultural Credit in India, consider the following statements:

1. Regional Rural Banks provide credit particularly to small and marginal farmers, agricultural laborers, artisan and small entrepreneurs.
2. They cannot issue credit cards to its customers.
3. RRB's can access the marginal standing facility of the RBI, if required.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 2 and 3 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.25) With reference to Agricultural Credit, consider the following statements:

1. Microfinance Institutions only cater to the agricultural sector.
2. NABARD gives direct loans to the eligible farmers for targeted delivery of credit.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.26) Consider the following statements:

1. Kisan Credit Card covers post-harvest expenses, produce marketing loan and consumption requirements of farmer households.

2. Farmers involved in the crop production or allied activities such as animal husbandry, fisheries are eligible for Kisan Credit Card Loan Scheme.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.27) Consider the following Pairs:

Schemes	Features
1. Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana	Enrolment
100% compulsory for all farmers.	
2. Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi	Covers all
farmer families.	
3. Rashtriya Gokul Mission	Nakul
Prajnan Bazaar is an initiative under it.	

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.28) In the context of Rubber Plantation in India, consider the following:

1. Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Jharkhand, Bihar, and Karnataka are the top rubber growing states in the country.
2. 100% Foreign Direct Investment is allowed in the plantations of rubber.
3. It cannot be grown in the tropical and the subtropical areas.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 3
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.29) With reference to the advantages of Farmer Producer Organizations, consider the following statements:

1. The FPO can provide low-cost quality inputs to member farmers.
2. They can decide the Minimum Support Prices of the commodities efficiently.
3. FPOs can engage farmers in collective farming.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 only
- d) 1 and 3 only



Q.30) Consider the following statements regarding Urban development in India:

1. AMRUT Mission covers 500 cities with a population greater than 1 lakh.
2. The selection of cities under SMART cities is the sole responsibility of the state government.
3. Internships under TULIP are funded through the budgetary allocation.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.31) Consider the following:

1. Affordable housing complexes
2. Subsidies to builders providing more than 35% of apartments to the EWS category.
3. Skill development for rural masons.
4. A sum of 5 lakhs for renovation of the house.
5. Redevelopment of slums.

Which of the above-mentioned benefits are provided under the PM Awas Yojana?

- a) 1, 2, 3, and 5 only
- b) 1, 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 2, 3, 4, and 5 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5

Q.32) In relation to the MPLADS (Member of Parliament Local Area Development) Scheme, consider the following statements:

1. It allows an MP to undertake a project outside his/her constituency at the time of natural disasters.
2. The scheme provides fund quota for SCs, STs, and the PH over and above the allocated limit.
3. Nominated MPs are required to choose a district from their home state.
4. An MP is allocated Rs. 5 crore per constituency for a period of 5 years or till the time he holds his seat in the Parliament.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1, 2, and 3 only
- b) 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 1, 3, and 4 only
- d) 3 and 4 only

Q.33) Consider the following statements regarding Rural Infrastructure development:

1. PM Adarsh Gram Yojana is applicable for the villages with more than 50% of the SC population.
2. Srijan Portal aims at enhancing the local manufacturing of the electronic hardware components.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.34) Consider the following bodies/offices/organizations:

1. Universal Service Obligation Fund
2. Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC).
3. Data Security Council of India.
4. National Informatics Centre

Which of the above-mentioned organizations are under the control of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology?

- a) 1 and 4 only
- b) 2 and 4 only
- c) 1, 3, and 4 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.35) Which of the following were the outcomes of India's Liberalization, Privatization, and Globalization reforms of 1991?

1. Grant of Ratna status to Central Public Sector Enterprises.

2. Focus on heavy industries.
3. Abolition of quota from all the industries.
4. Allowing the private sector in aviation and telecommunication.
5. End of the practice of Nationalisation.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1, 2, and 4 only
- b) 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 1, 4, and 5 only
- d) 2, 3, and 5 only

Q.36) Which of the following are the favorable manufacturing techniques from the perspective of a circular economy?

1. Increasing the life of a product.
2. Short term renting of electronic gadgets.
3. Avoidance of single use plastics.
4. Sharing a business platform for mutually compatible purposes.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 2 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, and 4

Q.37) Consider the following statements regarding start-up ecosystem in India:

1. India is amongst the top three nations of the world that recorded maximum registration of the new firms.
2. For every 10% increase in the registration of firms in a district, there is an increase of 1.8% in the GDP of the country.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.38) Which one of the following statements is least appropriate regarding the concept of Evergreening of patents?

- a) Indian Patents Act provides exemption from Evergreening after receiving royalty by the holder.
- b) It is the minor change done in the original production process to obtain a new patent.
- c) Patent protection rights are recognized within the territorial borders and for a fixed period.
- d) Prohibition of Evergreen is likely to reduce the cost of life saving drugs for the people.

Q.39) Consider the following statements regarding the Code on wages, 2019:

1. It gives the employers the right to deduct the workers' wage in certain situations like absence, penalty, etc.
2. The Minimum wages are decided after considering the minimum standard of living.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.40) Consider the following statements regarding the transport infrastructure of the country:

1. Road transport forms a major portion of the overall Gross Value Addition by the transport sector.
2. India has the largest network of roads (including rural-urban, national, and state highways) across the globe.
3. Around 95% of India's external trade is done via the sea route.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.41) Consider the following statements regarding the National Policy on Electronics, 2019:

1. Sovereign Patent Funds have been proposed as a part of this policy.
2. The policy lays down clear targets for the production and export of the mobile handsets.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.42) Consider the following factors:

1. Export of assembled goods to the richer countries.
2. Surge in protectionist policies among the countries.
3. Lack of Demographic dividend.
4. Political instability
5. Improved transport and communication infrastructure.

Which of the above factors are likely to act as an obstacle for India to be a part of the global assembly chain for the Networked products?

- a) 1, 2, 3, and 5 only
- b) 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 1, 2, 3, and 4 only
- d) 2 and 4 only

Q.43) Consider the following statements regarding Investment models:

1. In Build-Operate-Transfer and Engineering Procurement construction models, the ownership is with the private sector till the expiry of contract.
2. The difference between Build-Lease-Transfer and Toll-Operate-Transfer is that the former involves upfront fees paid by the private operator to the Government.
3. In Hybrid Annuity Model, the private and public player alternately undertakes the operation of the project.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.44) In the light of the Indian Economic survey 2019-2020, consider the following observations:

1. India is expected to become the third largest overall aviation (domestic and international) market by 2025.
2. The average turnaround time of the ships at the ports have almost halved from its 2011 level.
3. The remarkable domination of wireless telephony has reduced the share of landline telephones to less than 2 %.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.45) In relation to the Telecom operations in India, consider the following statements:

1. The present system provides separate procedures for obtaining the license and the spectrum for the operation.
2. Adjusted Gross Revenue is an annual fee paid by private operators to the Government.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.46) Consider the following reforms regarding Manufacturing in India:

1. Environmentally sustainable growth.
2. Increase in Global competitiveness.



3. 100 million additional jobs by 2025.
4. 10% increase in the share of Manufacturing in GDP.

Which of the above are enumerated in the Make in India programme of the government?

- a) 2, 3, and 4 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1, 2, 3, and 4
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.47) Consider the following pairs:

- | | |
|------------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Industrial Revolution 1.0 | Steam Engine |
| 2. Industrial Revolution 2.0 | Gas and Oil |
| 3. Industrial Revolution 3.0 | Combustion Engine |
| 4. Industrial Revolution 4.0 | Automation and Robotics |

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 4 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 1 and 2 only

Q.48) In relation to the Insurance sector, consider the following statements:

1. The Nationalization of the Insurance sector occurred during the tenure of Indira Gandhi.
2. At present, 100% FDI is permitted in the Insurance brokers.
3. More than 70% of the Insurance market is dominated by LIC.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1, 2, and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.49) In the midst of COVID pandemic, it is believed that Atmanirbhar Bharat is the need of the hour.

Which of the following would aid India in its path of Self-reliance or Atmanirbhar?

1. Disinvestment of the PSUs.
2. Ease of Doing Business.
3. Credit Guarantee for the MSMEs.
4. Networked Products.
5. Increasing FDI

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1, 2, 3, and 4
- b) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
- c) 2, 4, and 5
- d) 2, 3, and 5

Q.50) Consider the following statements:

1. Insurance penetration and Insurance density are measured as a ratio of premiums with GDP and Population, respectively.
2. India penetration and density for life insurance is around three times that of other insurance products.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.51) Which of the following best describes the *Plug and Play* model for India, as suggested by the current Prime Minister?

- a) It seeks to promote automation where all devices would be plugged to a digital system and the user simply needs to play them.
- b) The government would provide infrastructure and policy support while the private players need to just start the business.
- c) Disinvestment of Public Sector to allow private players to integrate the current PSUs with their advanced technical expertise.



- d) Permitting private sectors to integrate their technical expertise with the creation, distribution, and implementation of the welfare policies.

Q.52) Which of the statements given below are correct regarding the Start-ups in India?

1. They are less than a decade old entity with a turnover less than 100 crore in any financial year.
2. They are included in the Priority Sector Lending norms of the RBI.
3. They are eligible for tax holidays for three consecutive years before or after 10 years of their inception.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.53) In respect to the recent changes in the definition of the MSME, which of the statements given below is/are correct?

1. The earlier classification of MSMEs based on investment have been changed to turnover based.
2. The distinction between the Manufacturing and services have been done away with.
3. In estimating the turnover of MSMEs, the exports done are not taken into consideration.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.54) The terms sportstech, mobiltech, oekotech, packtech often seen in the news are related to?

- a) Technical Textiles
- b) Virtual and Augmented Reality
- c) High-Tech parks

- d) Autonomous vehicles

Q.55) In relation to the Production Linked Incentive Scheme for electronics, consider the following statements:

1. It is an outcome and growth-based model to provide incentives based on incremental production.
2. It is a WTO compliant scheme and includes incentives for the export and value addition to the goods.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.56) The term network effects in news regarding E-commerce can be best described as?

- a) It refers to the forward and backward linkages in the production of a commodity.
- b) Comparative advantage to a larger firm due to larger sources of accessible data.
- c) It refers to the positive and negative effects on the disruption of the interconnected global supply chains.
- d) It indicates the connection between sellers and the E-commerce platform in a market based model.

Q.57) In relation to the SANKALP and STRIVE schemes, which of the statements given below is/are correct?

1. Both are World Bank assisted schemes with the aim to ensure skill development.
2. SANKALP deals with the enrichment of the skills through the Industrial Training Institutes or ITIs.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only

- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.58) Consider the following statements with respect to Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC):

1. It is a statutory body to plan, promote, and develop khadi and village industries in rural areas.
2. It is an apex organization under the Ministry of Rural Development.
3. It plays an essential role in imparting industrial level skills to Indian youth through Pradhan Mantri Employment Generation Program (PMEGP).

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3 only

Q.59) Which of the following statements is/are incorrect regarding Micro Unit development and refinance agency (MUDRA)?

1. It provides loans at low interest rates to micro financial institutions and NBFCs for farming and small industries.
2. It has been formed as a wholly owned subsidiary of NABARD.
3. Shishu, Tarun, and Kishor are the subcategories of loan in the increasing order of limit for the loan disbursement.

Select the incorrect answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3 only

Q.60) With respect to the E-commerce negotiations at the WTO, consider the following statements:

1. WTO norms impose permanent binding prohibition on the custom duties on e-commerce.
2. India is a party to the above negotiation with the exemption of imposing reduced and fixed custom duty.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.61) Consider the following statements with reference to Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS)

1. To be eligible, accounts must have paid dues on time or be at least SMA-0, SMA-1, SMA-2 (SMA = Special Mention account) and not in NPA (Non-Performing asset) category.
2. National Credit Guarantee Trust Company (NCGTC), responsible for ECLGS, is a private limited Company

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.62) Consider the following sectors about tourism Sector in India:

1. The number of tourists arriving in India has consistently increased in the last 5 years before the arrival of Pandemic.

2. The highest number of foreign tourists who visit India are from Bangladesh.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.63) Consider the following statements about MSME Sector:

- 1. The new definition keeps different investment limits for manufacturing and services enterprises.
- 2. Exports shall not be counted while calculating the turnover of enterprise
- 3. The MSME can be established by undertaking registration in online mode through self declaration.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.64) With reference to Indian economy, consider the following statements:

- 1. Primary sector comprises more than half of the employed workforce of the Indian economy.
- 2. Contraction has been witnessed in the service, industries and Agriculture sector in financial year 2020-2021 in the backdrop of pandemic

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.65) Consider the following statements as per the amendments to the Consumer Protection (E-commerce) Rules, 2020:

- 1. Flash sales have been promoted in the amended rules to benefit the consumers.
- 2. Every e-commerce firm is required to register with the Department of Consumer affairs.
- 3. E-commerce firms can be held liable in case a seller on their platform fails to deliver goods or services in timely manner

Which of the above statement/s is/are incorrect?

Select the answer from the code given below:

- a) 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.66) Among the services imported by India, which one of the following accounts for the highest imports in terms of value in the last five years?

- a) Transport
- b) Telecommunication
- c) Financial Services
- d) Travel

Q.67) Consider the following statements about Indian economy:

- 1. Revenue of Tax as percent of GDP has increased substantially in the last decade.
- 2. To achieve development goals, the capital expenditure as percent of total expenditure has consistently increased in the last 5 years.

Select the Correct statements from the code given below

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.68) Consider the following statements about intellectual property appellate board:

- 1. It is a statutory body created under the provisions of Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999.
- 2. It falls under the administrative control of the Ministry of Commerce.
- 3. It strengthens the IPR regime influencing the inflows of foreign direct investment and trade in the country

Select the Correct statements from the code given below

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.69) Which of the following are part of transfer payments?

- 1. Remittances received by people residing in India
- 2. Imported Petro-Chemical products.



3. Grants from multilateral institutions.

Select the answer from the code given below:

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 1 only

Q.70) Consider the following statements about research and development in India:

- 1. Private sectors contribute a majority share in gross domestic expenditure on R&D.
- 2. The non-residents are responsible for the majority of patents and trademarks filed in India.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.71) 'eSagu' was often seen in the news related to -

- a) It is a web-based personalized agro-advisory system.
- b) It is a monitoring system for teak plants in tropical regions.
- c) It is a digital platform to sell tribal handicraft.
- d) None the above

Q.72) With reference to the 'Coal based Hydrogen Production', consider the following Statements :

- 1. The Ministry of Mining Constituted a Task Force and Expert Committee under the chairmanship of R.K. Malhotra to Prepare a Road Map for Coal-based Hydrogen Production.
- 2. Cost of Hydrogen produced from coal can be cheaper and less sensitive to imports.
- 3. It can be stored physically only in gaseous form.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 Only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 2 ,3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.73) With reference to 'Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission', consider the following Statements :

- 1. It will connect the digital health solutions of hospitals across the country with each other.
- 2. The mission will provide a digital health ID to the people.

3. The National Health Authority is the nodal agency to implement this project.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 Only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.74) Consider the following statements, with reference to 'Meenakari Painting':

- 1. It is the process of painting and colouring the surfaces of metals and ceramic tiles.
- 2. It originated in the Indian Subcontinent.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.75) Recently, Assam's Judima rice wine was accorded a Geographical Indication Tag, Consider the following Statements regarding it :

- 1. It is a home-made rice wine by the Dimasa tribe.
- 2. It is made from sticky rice, which is steamed and mixed with traditional herbs.
- 3. It is the first product from the North-East to get a GI Tag.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.76) Consider the following statements regarding the International Labour Organisation(ILO).

- 1. It is the only tripartite U.N. agency that brings together governments, NGOs and public servants.
- 2. It sets international labour standards, promotes rights at work and encourages decent employment opportunities.
- 3. In 2020, India assumed the chairmanship of governing body international labour organisation.
- 4. Global Wage Report released by the international labour organisation.

Which of the statements given above is/are not correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 4 only
- c) 1, 2 and 4 only
- d) 1,2,3, and 4

Q.77) 'I-Familia', which was sometime seen in the news is -

- Global database for missing school girls through fingerprints.
- Global database to identify missing persons through family DNA.
- Global database of missing women through family DNA.
- Global database to establish gender parity at the workplace.

Q.78) Consider the following statements:

- Seed Minikit Programme aims to distribute high yielding varieties of seeds of pulses and oilseeds to farmers.
- Horticulture Cluster Development Programme is a central sector programme.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2.

Q.79) Consider the following statements;

- Konark Sun temple is listed as one of the World Heritage Sites by UNESCO.
- Konark Sun Temple was built during the reign of Narasimhadeva-I the great ruler of the Ganga dynasty.
- Lingaraja Temple is a Hindu temple dedicated to Shiva and is one of the oldest temples in Bhubaneswar.
- The Lingaraj temple was built by the kings from the cholas dynasty.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 and 4 only
- 2 and 3 only
- 1, 2 and 3 only
- 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q.80) Which one of the following statements is/ are incorrect about TRIFOOD Parks?

- It is a joint initiative of TRIFED and the Ministry of Food Processing.
- TRIFOOD Parks are food processing centres aiming at promoting value addition to major forest produce.

- The parks procure raw materials from the Van Dhan Kendras and process them to be sold across the country through Tribes India outlets.

Select the correct answer using codes given below:

- 1 only
- 2 only
- 1 and 3 only
- 2 and 3 only

Q.81) Recently, UNESCO has designated the world's first biosphere spread across five different countries. Which of the following countries are part of this biosphere?

- Germany
- Austria
- Spain
- Croatia
- Hungary
- Serbia

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- 1, 2, 4, 5 only
- 1, 2, 4, 6 only
- 1, 3, 4, 5 only
- 2, 4, 5, 6 only

Q.82) Recently, New species of ' Hybodont Shark ' of the Jurassic age was found in Rajasthan's Jaisalmer, Consider the following Statements regarding it:

- Hybodonts survived in freshwater environments during the Jurassic periods.
- It was an endemic species in the Indian Ocean.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

Q.83) Recently, Which of the following States declared India's first dugong conservation reserve ?

- Andhra Pradesh
- Kerala
- Tamil Nadu
- Maharashtra

Q.84) With reference to the 'Energy Return On Investment (EROI) ' , consider the following Statements :



1. It is a ratio for describing a measure of energy produced in relation to the energy used to create it.
2. EROI is an important determinant in energy commodity and electricity pricing.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.85) Which of the following is /are the features of 'Green Building'?

1. Good indoor environmental air quality.
2. Reduced dependence on conventional sources of energy
3. Building materials can be more expensive.
4. Use more efficient and renewable materials for construction.
5. A design that enables adaptation to a changing environment.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1, 2, 4 and 5 only
- b) 1, 2 and 4 only
- c) 1, 3, 4 and 5 only
- d) All the above

Q.86) With reference to 'Green Investing', consider the following Statements:

1. These are investment activities that focus on companies or projects committed to the conservation of natural resources.
2. The main objective is to earn a huge amount of profit from the investors.
3. Buying green mutual funds, green index funds, green ETFs, green bonds are few examples of green investment.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 Only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 2, 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.87) With reference to the 'Renewable Energy Certificates (RECs)', consider the following Statements :

1. It is a market-based instrument to promote renewable sources of energy and development of the market in electricity.

2. Renewable Energy Certificates can not be sold on the open market as an energy commodity.
3. The price of RECs is determined by market demand.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 Only
- b) 2, 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All the above

Q.88) A report titled "Mapping India's Climate Vulnerability – A District-level Assessment" has been released by -

- a) World Wildlife Fund
- b) Council on Energy, Environment and Water
- c) United Nation Development Program
- d) The Ministry Environment and Forests

Q.89) Consider the following statements about world sustainable development summit 2021:

1. It is organised by the United Nations Environment Agency.
2. The theme of the Summit is 'Redefining our common future: Safe and secure environment for all'.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.90) Which of the following statements regarding 'Green climate fund' is/ are incorrect?

1. It is intended to assist the developed countries in the adaptation and mitigation practices to counter climate change.
2. It is founded under the aegis of UNEP, OECD Asian Development Bank and World Bank.

Select the incorrect answer using the code given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.91) Which of the following statements is associated with the issue of control and phasing out of the use of persistent organic pollutants:

- a) Montreal protocol
- b) Kyoto protocol
- c) Rotterdam convention

d) Stockholm convention

Q.92) Which one of the following is the best description of the term "Eutrophication" ?

1. Eutrophication is a syndrome of the ecosystem, response to the addition of artificial or natural nutrients such as nitrates and phosphate through fertilizer and sewage.
2. Eutrophication is a disease of biosphere response to the addition of only artificial nutrients such as nitrates and phosphate through fertilizer and sewage.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.93) Which of the following statements regarding 'carbon credits':

1. The carbon credit system was ratified in conjunction with the Kyoto Protocol.
2. Carbon credits are traded at a price fixed from time to time by the United Nations Environment Programme.

Select the correct answer using code given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.94) Consider the following benefits of 'Ethanol Blending' :

1. It is a plant-based fuel and considered as an environmentally friendly fuel.
2. It helps to reduce the country's carbon footprint.
3. It is derived from sugarcane and food grains so, It gives extra income to farmers.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All the above

Q.95) With reference to 'Blue carbon', consider the following Statements :

1. Blue carbon is the carbon stored in coastal and marine ecosystems.

2. Coastal and marine ecosystems sequester and store more carbon per unit area than terrestrial forests.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.96) He first created the 'Indian Society of Oriental Art' and later went on to establish the Bengal school of art. He was the creator of the iconic 'Bharat Mata' painting. His unique interpretation of swadeshi themes created a new awakening and heralded a revival of Indian art.

Which of the following personality does the above paragraph refer to?

- a) M.F Hussain
- b) Raja Ravi Varma
- c) Nandalal Bose
- d) Abanindranath Tagore

Q.97) Consider the following with respect to Preventive Detention in India:

1. Preventive detention must fall within Article 21 (due process of law) read with Article 20 (Protection in Respect of Conviction for Offences)
2. Every person who is arrested shall be produced before the nearest magistrate within a period of 24 hours of such arrest including the time necessary for the journey
3. The 44th Amendment Act of 1978 has reduced the period of detention without obtaining the opinion of an advisory board from three to two months.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.98) KVIC has secured Patent registration for its innovation under Project "REPLAN" recently. Project "REPLAN" aims to -

- a) REduce PLanetary Activities Against Nature
- b) REuse Plastics for LANDscape building
- c) REducing PLastic in Nature
- d) RENewable Production using LASer Nanotechnology



Q.99) Considering the following with respect to Pricing policy of Sugar and Sugarcane in India:

1. Minimum Selling Price of sugar is announced by government in conformity with the Essential Commodities Act, 1955,
2. Minimum Selling Price of sugar is fixed taking into account the components of Fair & Remunerative Price (FRP) of sugarcane and minimum conversion cost of the most inefficient mills
3. Fair and remunerative price (FRP) is the minimum price at which sugarcane is to be purchased by sugar mills from farmers.

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.100) Consider the following pairs:

Species	IUCN Red list Status
1. Gharial.	- Critically Endangered
2. Mugger Crocodile.	- Least Concern
3. Saltwater Crocodile	- Vulnerable.

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2
- c) 3 only
- d) 2 and 3



Q.1) Ans: A

Exp:

Options 1, 2 and 5 are correct:

The term 'institutional factors' refers to the particular system under which land is owned and managed. The ownership and management have a direct bearing on agricultural productivity and efficiency. The components of institutional factors in agriculture are land reforms, Computerisation of Land Records, Abolition of Intermediaries, Land Ceiling Act etc.

Q.2) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Temperature has a great bearing on the cropping pattern of an area because each crop requires specific temperatures for its growth and development. Example-Some crops require higher temperature and are sown in the summer season. These are known as the Kharif Crops. In a similar way, some crops which require lower temperature and are sown in the winter season. They are known as the Rabi Crops.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Monocropping is the agricultural practice of growing a single crop year after year on the same land. Crops like Maize, soybeans, and wheat are often grown using monocropping techniques. Monocropping allows for farmers to have consistent crops throughout their entire farm, which may increase overall farm profitability. However, monocropping can lead to the quicker buildup of pests and diseases, and then their rapid spread where a uniform crop is susceptible to a pathogen.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Prices and Income Maximisation influence the acreage under crops in many ways- The price differential between two crops leads to change in cropping pattern in favour of crops that give better returns, The crops which assure more stable incomes get favoured by farmers and the Minimum Support Price offered for crops also affect the Combination of crops favoured by farmers.

Q.3) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Central Sector Scheme are the schemes that are entirely and directly funded and executed by the central government. The schemes are formulated by the Centre, based on subjects from the Union List. Agriculture Infrastructure Fund is a Central Sector Scheme to provide medium - long term debt financing facility

for investment in viable projects for post-harvest management Infrastructure and community farming assets.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Under the scheme, Rs. 1 Lakh Crore will be provided by banks and financial institutions as loans to the eligible beneficiaries. All loans under this financing facility will have interest subvention of 3% per annum up to a limit of Rs. 2 crore. This subvention will be available for a maximum period of 7 years. Further, credit guarantee coverage will be available for eligible borrowers from this financing facility under Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro and Small Enterprises (CGTMSE) scheme for a loan up to Rs. 2 crore.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Eligible Beneficiaries under the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund are Farmers, FPOs, PACS, Marketing Cooperative Societies, SHGs, Joint Liability Groups (JLG), Multipurpose Cooperative Societies, Agri-entrepreneurs, Start-ups, and Central/State agency or Local Body sponsored Public-Private Partnership (PPP) Projects.

Q.4) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare has launched a Scheme on Internship Programme (SIP) i.e. Sahakar Mitra. It is an initiative by the National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC) for young professionals. It is expected to be beneficial for both i.e. cooperatives as well as for the young professionals. The Sahakar Mitra scheme will help cooperative institutions access new and innovative ideas of young professionals while the interns will gain experience of working in the field to be self-reliant.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Bhavantar Bhugtan Yojana in Madhya Pradesh was sought to provide relief to farmers by providing the differential between MSPs and market prices. The basic purpose of the scheme was to compensate farmers in the event of a price crash and to that extent hedge the price risk faced by them. Farmers who register under the scheme are compensated only if their selling price (SP) is lower than the government set minimum support price (MSP).
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Zero tillage is the process where the crop seed will be sown through drillers without prior land preparation and disturbing the

soil where previous crop stubbles are present. Zero tillage not only reduces the cost of cultivation it also reduces the soil erosion, crop duration and irrigation requirement but also helps in carbon sequestration.

Q.5) Ans: D

Exp:

Krishi Megh is the data recovery centre of Indian Council of Agricultural Research. The data recovery centre has been set up at National Academy of Agricultural Research Management, Hyderabad. It has been set up under the National Agricultural Higher Education Project (NAHEP), funded by both the government and the World Bank. It has been built to mitigate the risk, enhance the quality, availability and accessibility of e-governance, research, extension and education in the field of agriculture in India.

Q.6) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Being leguminous crops, all these crops except arhar help in restoring soil fertility by fixing nitrogen from the air. They absorb N₂ from the soil atmosphere into small nodules on their roots and the bacteria (rhizobia) in the nodules convert the atmospheric N₂ into ammonia (NH₃). The ammonia is then converted into organic compounds by the plant and used for growth. Therefore, these are mostly grown in rotation with other crops.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Major pulse producing states in India are Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Maharashtra and Karnataka. Madhya Pradesh is India's largest pulse producing state, which accounts for 23% of total pulse production in the country. Madhya Pradesh is followed by Uttar Pradesh (18%), Maharashtra (14%), Rajasthan (11%) and Andhra Pradesh (9%).
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Pulse crops are cultivated in Kharif, Rabi and Zaid seasons of the Agricultural year. It is an all season crop. An All Season Crop. Pulses grown during the Kharif Season are :Arhar (Tur), Urd (Blackgram), Moong (Greengram), Lobia (Cowpea), Kulthi. (Horsegram) and Pulses grown during the Rabi Season are :Gram, Lentil, Pea, Lathyrus and Rajmash. Summer: Greengram, Blackgram and Cowpea.

Q.7) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** India ranks first in number of organic farmers and ninth in terms of area under organic farming. Sikkim became the first State in the world to become fully organic and other States including Tripura and Uttarakhand have set similar targets. Lakshadweep is second after Sikkim to achieve the status of 100% organic region. It is first in the Union Territories of India to achieve the status.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Organic farming in India is an agricultural process, uses pest control derived from organic manure and animal or plant waste. This farming started to respond to the environmental suffering caused by chemical pesticides and synthetic fertilizers. No synthetic fertilisers are used in this kind of farming. However, natural herbicides, natural pesticides and bio fertilizers etc are used in organic farming.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** India Organic is a certification mark for organically farmed food products manufactured in India. The certification is issued by testing centres accredited by the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA). under the National Program for Organic Production of the Government of India.

Q.8) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** APEDA is mandated with the responsibility of promotion and development of the export of agricultural and its allied products. APEDA is mandated with the responsibility of export promotion and development of the following scheduled products: Fruits, Vegetables and their Products. Meat and Meat Products, Poultry and Poultry Products, Dairy Products, Confectionery, Biscuits and Bakery Products, Honey, Jaggery and Sugar Products, Cocoa and its products, chocolates of all kinds, Alcoholic and Non-Alcoholic Beverages, Cereal and Cereal Products, Groundnuts, Peanuts and Walnuts, Pickles, Papads and Chutneys, Guar Gum, Floriculture and Floriculture Products and Herbal and Medicinal Plants.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** APEDA is a statutory body established under the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority Act 1985. It functions under the Union Ministry of Commerce and Industry. APEDA

replaced the Processed Food Export Promotion Council (PFEPCC).

- **Statement 3 is correct:** APEDA has been entrusted with the responsibility to monitor import of sugar.

Q.9) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) Commission takes into account the following factors while determining the MSP- Cost of production, Changes in input prices, Input-output price parity, Trends in market prices, Demand and supply, Inter-crop price parity, Effect on industrial cost structure, Effect on cost of living, Effect on general price level, International price situation, Parity between prices paid and prices received by the farmers and Effect on issue prices and implications for subsidy.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Amber Box contains subsidies that distort the international trade by making products of a particular country cheaper in the international market as compared to the same or similar product from another country is slotted under this box. They distort trade balance because they encourage excessive production. Example - Input subsidies such as subsidy on electricity, seeds, fertilizers, irrigation etc. Market support price (MSP) subsidies also fall under this box.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Price at which the FCI sells the food grain for PDS consumption is known as Issue Price. Whereas, Minimum Support Price (MSP) is the minimum price set by the government for certain agricultural products, at which the products would directly be bought from the farmers if the open market prices are less than the cost incurred.

Q.10) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** Primitive subsistence agriculture is practised on small patches of land with the help of primitive tools like hoe, dao and digging sticks, and family/community labour. This type of farming depends upon monsoon, natural fertility of the soil and suitability of other environmental conditions to the crops grown.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** Mixed farming refers to cultivation of food or cash crops, feed crops, and livestock on the same farm simultaneously. The

livestocks are complementary to crop production so as to provide a balanced and productive system of farming as the crop and animal components in the farm support each other.

- **Pair 3 is correct:** Intensive Farming is a farming method that uses higher inputs and advanced agricultural techniques to increase the overall yield in the given limited land space with a high dependency on fertilizers, labor, and machinery.

Q.11) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Plantation agriculture is a type of commercial farming (farming that mainly focuses on commercial crops that give a good amount of profit in return and they can be grown in all the seasons) in which a single crop is grown for the entire year. This type of farming requires a large amount of labour and capital. The crop production may be further processed on the farm itself where it is grown or in nearby factories or small scale industries.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The term plantation crop refers to those crops which are cultivated on an extensive scale in contiguous areas, owned and managed by an individual or a company. The crops include tea, coffee, rubber, cocoa, coconut, arecanut, oil palm, palmyrah and cashew, rice, coconut, maize, sugarcane, banana, cassava, coffee, mango, sweet potato, Manila hemp etc. Therefore, both food and non food crops are grown in Plantation Agriculture.

Q.12) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Operation Green is a price fixation scheme that aims to ensure farmers get the right price for the crops they produce. The scheme focuses on organized marketing of all fruits and vegetables by establishing connections between farmers and consumers. Recently, Operation Green was extended from tomatoes, onions, and potatoes (TOP) to all fruits and vegetables (TOTAL).
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** "Operation Greens" was announced on the line of "Operation Flood", with an outlay of Rs.500 crore to promote Farmer Producers Organizations, agri-logistics, processing facilities and professional management. Recently it was announced that Operation Green will be expanded with an additional fund of Rs 500 crore

and extended from tomatoes, onions and potatoes to all fruits and vegetables. The government will also help in the development of 22,000 agricultural markets.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Ministry of Food Processing Industries has launched the scheme. NAFED will be the Nodal Agency to implement price stabilisation measures under the Short term. The scheme will feature a 50% subsidy on transportation from surplus to deficient markets and 50% subsidy on storage, including cold storage.

Q.13) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution oversees the Essential Commodities Act. The Act gives powers to the central government to add or remove a commodity in the Schedule. The Centre, if it is satisfied that it is necessary to do so in public interest, can notify an item as essential, in consultation with state governments.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** By declaring a commodity as essential, the government can control the production, supply, and distribution of that commodity, and impose a stock limit. Additionally, the government can also fix the minimum support price (MSP) of any packaged product that it declares an "essential commodity".
- **Statement 3 is correct:** According to the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, which implements the Act, the Schedule at present contains seven commodities — drugs; fertilisers, whether inorganic, organic or mixed; foodstuffs including edible oils; hank yarn made wholly from cotton; petroleum and petroleum products; raw jute and jute textiles; seeds of food-crops and seeds of fruits and vegetables, seeds of cattle fodder, jute seed, cotton seed.

Q.14) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 and Statement 2 is correct: Crop residues are materials left in an agricultural field after the crop has been harvested. These residues include stalks and stubble (stems), leaves and seed pods. Leaving the Crop residues on the field itself has many advantages- helps in maintaining the soil surface cover, It protects soil from wind and rain erosion,

conserves soil moisture, can increase efficiency of irrigation and improves infiltration and aeration within the soil profile. Crop residues (or plant litter) on the soil surface decrease soil erosion, increase soil organic matter, improve soil quality, and reduce amounts of nutrients and pesticides that reach streams and rivers.

Q.15) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Jute is known as the golden fibre and is India's major cash crop. The suitable climate for growing jute is a warm and wet climate, which is offered by the monsoon climate during the fall season, immediately followed by summer. Temperatures ranging to more than 25 °C and relative humidity of 70%–90% are favourable for successful cultivation. Jute is primarily grown in West Bengal, Odisha, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Andhra Pradesh.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Asafoetida thrives in dry and cold desert conditions and can withstand a maximum temperature between 35 and 40 degrees, whereas, during winters, it can survive in temperatures up to minus 4 degrees. During extreme weather, the plant can get dormant. It is endemic to Iran and Afghanistan. Recently, Farmers of the remote Lahaul Valley in Himachal Pradesh have started taking up cultivation of asafoetida (hing).
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Tea requires a temperature ranging from 21°C to 29°C. Tea grows well in the regions which receive rainfall in between 150-200 cm. The soil should be well drained. Heavy rainfall but no stagnancy of water, such mountain slopes are good for tea cultivation. The stagnant water damages the tea crops.

Q.16) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** SHC is a printed report that a farmer will be handed over for each of his holdings. It contains the status of his soil with respect to 12 parameters, namely N,P,K (Macronutrients) ; S (Secondary- nutrient) ; Zn, Fe, Cu, Mn, Bo (Micro nutrients) ; and pH, EC, OC (Physical parameters).
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The objectives of the Soil Health Card (SHC) scheme are to issue soil health cards to farmers every two years so as to provide a basis to address nutritional deficiencies in

fertilization practices. The scheme has been introduced to assist State Governments to issue SHCs to all farmers in the country.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Based on the status of the soil, the Soil Health Card will indicate fertilizer recommendations and soil amendment required for the farm. It also provides two sets of fertilizer recommendations for six crops including recommendations of organic manures. However, Farmers can also get recommendations for additional crops on demand.

Q.17) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Direct-seeded crops showed better initial establishment and gave higher grain yield as compared to transplanted crops. Direct seeded crops require less labor and tend to mature faster than transplanted crops. In this method, plants are not subjected to stresses such as being pulled from the soil and re-establishing fine rootlets. However, they have more competition from weeds. Direct seeding method is becoming more popular among rice farmers as it is more economical than transplanting.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Transplanting of rice ensures a uniform plant stand and gives the rice crop a head start over emerging weeds. Further, seedlings are established even if the field is not levelled adequately and has variable water levels. Transplanting may also allow crop intensification as the crop is in the main field for less time.

Q.18) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Genetic modification of plants involves adding a specific stretch of DNA into the plant's genome, giving it new or different characteristics. The development of new biotechnological tools, such as RNA interference (RNAi), trans-grafting, cisgenesis/intragenesis, and genome editing tools, like zinc-finger and CRISPR/Cas9, has introduced the possibility of more precise and faster genetic modifications of plants.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Bt cotton is a genetically modified organism (GMO) or genetically modified pest resistant plant cotton variety. It is the only Genetically Modified (GM) crop that is allowed in

India. It has alien genes from the soil bacterium *Bacillus thuringiensis* (Bt) that allows the crop to develop a protein toxic to the common pest pink bollworm.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** RNA editing allows scientists to make changes in the molecules that carry the instructions needed to produce proteins, without changing the original DNA code. Unlike DNA editing, which is permanent, the effects of RNA editing are reversible and transient. RNA editing is therefore considered to be less risky.

Q.19) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Farmers are entitled to save, use, sow, re-sow, exchange, share or sell their farm produce, including seed of protected varieties, in the same manner as they were entitled to before the coming into force to the PPV&FR Act. However, farmers are not entitled to sell branded seed of a variety protected under this Act.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Act was adopted in 2001 in compliance with respect to obligations under the WTO context, especially under the TRIPS Agreement. Under TRIPS, it is an obligation for all countries to introduce some form of intellectual property protection for plant varieties. However, it does not impose the obligation for the introduction of patents and therefore leaves member states free to decide and devise their own legal framework in this regard (Sui Generis option)

Q.20) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The major characteristic of the Zero Budget Natural Farming is that the cost of production is zero and farmers do not have to buy any inputs to initiate this method of farming. natural farming, neither chemical nor organic fertilizers are added to the soil. In fact, no external fertilizers are added to soil or given to plants whatsoever.
- **Statement is correct:** Organic agriculture demands more labor, conventionally, the synthetic pesticides used to get the job of removing pests and weeds in the farmland. Now, farmers have to employ more laborers to remove weeds and pests. This increases the investment of the farmers and the price of the products. Post-

harvest processing and handling of organic food is also a costly affair since the risk of contamination by chemical fertilisers, pesticides, etc. from water and neighbouring farms is high. All these costs make Organic Farming more expensive than Natural Farming.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Vermicomposting which is a method of using earthworms as a means to enhance organic waste conversion; is not supported in Zero Budget Natural Farming. Subhash Palekar is the father of Zero Budget Natural Farming and according to him, vermicomposting is a “scandal” and Eiseniafoetida, the red worm used to make vermicompost, as the “destructor beast”. His own alternative of Zero Budget Natural Farming is, thus, posed against both inorganic farming and organic farming.

Q.21) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Aim of the Scheme is to supplement agriculture, to create processing and preservation capacities, to modernise and expand existing food processing units with a view to increasing the level of processing and to add value leading to the reduction of wastage.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Pradhan Mantri Kisan SAMPADA Yojana is a Central Sector Scheme under the Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI). The scheme aims at integrating existing and new schemes targeted at reducing food wastage, provide quality food to consumers at reasonable prices, and at the same time doubling farmer's income.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Seven component schemes under Pradhan Mantri Kisan SAMPADA Yojana: Mega Food Parks, Integrated Cold Chain and Value Addition Infrastructure, Infrastructure for Agro-Processing Clusters, Creation of Backward and Forward Linkages, Creation/Expansion of Food Processing & Preservation Capacities, Food Safety and Quality Assurance Infrastructure, Human Resources and Institutions.

Q.22) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In the hilly region of Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland and Tripura, shifting cultivation, locally known as jhum, continues to be

a dominant mode of food production and the economic mainstay of many rural households. Shifting agriculture is called by different names in different places. In the north eastern states of India, it is called Jhumming. It is called Dipa in Bastar district of Chattisgarh, Pamlou in Manipur, etc.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** In states like Assam, West Bengal and Odisha, three crops of paddy are grown in a year. These are Aus, Aman and Boro. Aman is sown in July-August and harvested in winter; aus sown in summer along with the pre-monsoon showers and harvested in autumn; and boro sown in winter and harvested in summer.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Madhuban Gajar is a biofortified carrot variety with high beta carotene and iron content developed by Shri Vallabhhai Vasrambhai Marvaniya, a farmer scientist from Junagadh district, Gujarat. The variety is being cultivated in Gujarat, Maharashtra, Rajasthan, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh during the last three years. This Variety of carrot possesses a significantly higher root yield and plant biomass.

Q.23) Ans:

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India (NAFED) is an apex Organisation under the Ministry of Agriculture, Government of India deals with marketing cooperatives for agricultural produce in India. It is also the central nodal agency for undertaking price support operations for pulses and oilseeds and market intervention operations for other agricultural commodities.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** In a data released by the Bangkok based Thai Rice Exporters Association, India has beaten Thailand to become the largest exporter of rice in the world. According to the reports, India has exported 10.23 million tons of rice in the year 2015 as compared to Thailand's 9.8 million tons. In terms of imports, China remains the number one importer of rice.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** India's agricultural exports grew 17.5 per cent to cross \$41.8 billion in 2020-21. This came even as the country's overall merchandise exports fell 7.2 per cent to \$290.8 billion, from \$313.4 billion in 2019-20. The farm sector's standout export performance, the best since the \$43.25 billion of 2013-14, was thanks to a good monsoon, agriculture production being relatively unaffected by the Covid-19-

induced lockdown, and a steep surge in global commodity prices.

Q.24) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Regional Rural Banks were established on the recommendations of Narasimham Committee on Rural Credit. It was felt that RRBs would be much better suited than the commercial banks or Co-Operative Banks in meeting the needs of rural areas. The main objective of RRB is to provide credit and other facilities particularly to small and marginal farmers, agricultural laborers, artisan and small entrepreneurs and develop agriculture, trade, commerce, industry, and other productive activities in the rural areas.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** In collaboration with their sponsor banks or other banks, RRBs may issue credit cards/debit cards to their constituents to be able to provide better facilities. In case any RRB wishes to set up an off-site ATM in its area of operation, it may do so after assessing the cost and benefit.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has allowed regional rural banks (RRBs) to access the liquidity adjustment facility (LAF), marginal standing facility (MSF) and call or notice money markets with the aim to facilitate better liquidity management for these lenders.

Q.25) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** MFIs are financial companies that provide small loans to people who do not have any access to banking facilities. They offer financial services to low income populations. These services include microloans, microsavings and microinsurance.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** NABARD provides Long Term and Medium Term Refinance to banks for providing adequate credit to farmers and rural artisans etc. for their investment activities. It is intended to create income-generating assets in the following sectors: Agriculture and allied activities. NABARD does not give direct loans to individuals. The selected financial institutions receive fundings from NABARD, and individuals can apply for loans at those selected institutions.

Q.26) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Kisan Credit Card scheme is a Government of India scheme which provides farmers with timely access to credit. The Kisan Credit Card (KCC) scheme was launched in 1998 with the aim of providing short-term formal credit to farmers and was created by NABARD. KCC covers post-harvest expenses, produce marketing loan, consumption requirements of farmer households, working capital for maintenance of farm assets and activities allied to agriculture, investment credit requirement for agriculture and allied activities.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The eligibility criteria for the Kisan Credit Card scheme are as follows—Any individual farmer who is an owner-cultivator; People who belong to a group and are joint borrowers—The group has to be owner-cultivators; Sharecroppers, tenant farmers, or an oral lessee are eligible for the KCC; Self-help groups (SHG) or joint liability groups (JLG) of sharecroppers, farmers, tenant farmers, etc; Farmers involved in the production of crop or allied activities such as animal husbandry along with non-farm activities such as fishermen.

Q.27) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is incorrect:** Recently, the Union Cabinet has approved the revamp of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY). The enrolment in these schemes has been made voluntary for all farmers, including those with existing crop loans. It has also allowed states the flexibility to select varied additional risk covers, with or without opting for the base PMFBY cover. The government has made it compulsory for the States to allow crop insurance firms to operate for three years.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN) is a central sector scheme. It provides for transfer of Rs. 6000/- per year in three equal instalments each of Rs. 2000/- directly into the bank account of beneficiary farmer families. The Scheme initially covered only small and marginal farmer families as beneficiaries, subject to certain exclusion criteria for higher-income status. The Government later extended the scheme to all farmer families irrespective of landholding size.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** Rashtriya Gokul Mission aims to conserve and develop indigenous breeds in a focused and scientific manner, Undertake breed improvement program for indigenous cattle

breeds so as to improve the genetic makeup and increase the stock, Enhance milk production and productivity and distribute disease free high genetic merit bulls for natural service. One of the initiatives under it is- E-Pashu Haat"- Nakul Prajnan Bazaar: An e-market portal connecting breeders and farmers, for quality- disease-free bovine germplasm.

Q.28) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** India is currently the sixth largest producer of NR in the world with one of the highest productivity. Top Rubber Producing States: Kerala > Tamil Nadu > Karnataka. Kerala is the largest producer of natural rubber in India, the main rubber producing districts of Kerala are Kottayam, Kollam, Ernakulam and Kozhikode. Other important producers are Tamil Nadu, Karnataka and Andaman and Nicobar Islands.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** There are several examples of Government initiatives for the development of the Rubber Sector like 100% Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) is allowed in plantations of rubber, coffee, tea, cardamom, palm oil tree and olive oil tree via the automatic route. Rubber Plantation Development Scheme and Rubber Group Planting Scheme are some examples of government led initiatives for rubber. The Department of Commerce brought out the National Rubber Policy in March 2019 to support the Natural Rubber production sector and the entire rubber industry value chain.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Rubber is an equatorial crop, but under special conditions, it is also grown in tropical and sub-tropical areas. The temperature should be above 25°C with a moist and humid climate. The rainfall should be more than 200 cm with well drained alluvial soil and adequate supply of cheap and skilled labour.

Q.29) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The FPO's can provide low-cost and quality inputs to member farmers. For example, loans for crops, purchase of machinery, input agri-inputs (fertilizers, pesticides, etc.) and direct marketing after procurement of agricultural produce. This will enable members to save in terms of time, transaction costs, distress sales, price fluctuations, transportation, quality maintenance, etc. They

can also reap the benefits of social capital through interaction among the member farmers.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Based on the recommendations of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP), the Department of Agriculture and Cooperation, Government of India, declares Minimum Support Price (MSP) for 22 crops before the sowing season.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The average farm size declined from 2.3 hectares (ha) in 1970-71 to 1.08 ha in 2015-16. The share of small and marginal farmers increased from 70 per cent in 1980-81 to 86 per cent in 2015-16. FPOs can engage farmers in collective farming and address productivity issues emanating from small farm sizes. They can leverage on the strengths of collectives to engage better with the market. Further, this may also result in additional employment generation due to the increased intensity of farming.

Q.30) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct: AMRUT (Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation, 2015)** is a core scheme under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Development. The main aim of the scheme is to ensure basic improvements in the infrastructure of the urban areas including transport, sewage, water supply, etc. It was envisaged as a five year scheme that covered 500 cities with a population more than 1 lakh.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect: SMART CITY Mission** is an important scheme for the development of enabling physical, social, and economic infrastructure in a selected city to ensure good quality of life, sustainable development, and ease of living for the inhabitants of the city. The selection of the city is the responsibility of the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Development.** The plan for the smart cities is prepared by the cities and then sent to the state government which then forwards it to the Ministry of Housing and Urban Development.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect: TULIP or The Urban Learning Internship Programme** is a joint initiative of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Development and the AICTE that aims to extend around 1 crore internships by the year 2025. The

internships are provided in the areas of urban planning, water supply, waste management and other related areas. They are not provided with a separate budgetary allocation. The urban local body however, may use the funds available under the smart cities, AMRUT mission funds.

Q.31) Ans: A

Exp:

Option A is correct: PM Awas Yojana is a core scheme of the Union government with two components focused on urban and rural areas. The **PMAY (Urban)** is under the control of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Development while **PMAY (Rural)** is under the control of the Ministry of Rural Development. The scheme aims to provide a number of benefits to promote urban and rural housing for all by 2022. It seeks to provide subsidies to the builder who intends to keep 35% of the apartment under his construction for the EWS category. For a person owning land in the urban area, the scheme provides a sum of Rs. 1.5 lakh for the purpose of building and renovating his house. It also seeks to undertake slum redevelopment in the urban areas. **Affordable Renting Housing Complexes** have been launched by the Ministry of Housing as a sub-component under PMAY (Urban). The scheme also contains provisions for the skill training of rural masons.

Q.32) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Member of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme (MPLADS)** is a central sector scheme under the **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation** wherein a Member of Parliament can suggest a development work worth Rs. 5 crore per year in his/her constituency. The scheme also provides for an MP to recommend development works worth Rs. 25 lakh per year out of his Rs. 5 crore quota in areas outside his/her constituency during the time of natural disasters
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The scheme envisages development works for the SCs (15% of the fund quota) and STs (7.5% of the fund quota) if the area contains a significant population of these.

Further, it also provides development works amounting to Rs. 20 lakhs/year for the welfare of the Physically Handicapped people. The above work needs to be done within the quota allocated.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Rajya Sabha MP can choose any district from the state which he represents while the nominated MPs are free to choose any district from anywhere in the country. The role of the MPs is to only recommend the work while it is the responsibility of the district collector to execute and implement the work.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The amount allocated in the scheme is Rs. 5 crore per constituency per year. The amount is not lapsable and is carried forward to the next year if unused.

Source: Mrunal 604

Q.33) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **PM Adarsh Gram Yojana** is implemented under the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment** and focuses on the villages with greater than 50 percent of the Scheduled Caste (SC) population. A village is declared as Adarsh Gram if it fulfills three of the listed targets like adult literacy, vaccination, no instances of child marriage, etc.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Srijan portal** aims at promoting indigenous production of defense related equipment. It contains a list of all the defense products that are imported and hence gives a picture of defense related items that can be indigenously manufactured. It also aims to promote interaction among the defense public sector undertakings with that of the industry.

Source: Mrunal 606, 608

Q.34) Ans: B

Exp:

Option is B correct: **Universal Service Obligation Fund** is under the Ministry of Telecommunication. It



aims to connect the rural and remote with the full and highly efficient telecommunication network. **Centre for the Development of the Advanced Computing or C-DAC** comes under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. It is the premier Research and Development organization and has implemented the National Mission on Supercomputers. **Data Security Council of India** is a not-for-profit organization formed by NASSCOM with the aim to protect data security. The **National Informatics Centre** is under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. It plays an important role in the delivery of the IT services to the Government by providing efficient infrastructure and promotes the Digital India initiative.

Source: Mrunal 609, 610

Q.35) Ans: C

Exp:

Option C is correct: Liberalization, Privatization, and Globalisation reforms were initiated by the country post the Balance of payment crisis of 1991 after the conditions for structural reforms were laid down by the IMF for availing loans. The reforms undertaken were: **Granting Ratna status** to the Central Public Enterprises. **Abolition of Quota from most of the industries** except for some like alcohol, tobacco, aerospace, defense, explosives, and hazardous chemicals. The **policy of Nationalization was stopped** and the **private sector was allowed to access the Banking, Insurance, telecommunication, and the aviation sectors**. The **focus on heavy industries** was laid down in the Industrial Policy Resolutions of 1956 much before the LPG reforms.

Source: Mrunal 437, 438

Q.36) Ans: D

Exp:

Option D is correct: A **circular economy** is the one in the product or the raw material used in the production process is recovered completely without any wastage. The main aim of the circular economy is

to leave nothing as a waste. The products that have a greater life cycle are likely to be part of the system for longer duration before they are being recycled and reused and hence would aid in the concept of circular economy. The renting of unused or old electronic gadgets is a practice that would limit the generation of e-waste considerably. The single use plastics have been a menace for quite a time and most governments are striving hard to phase them out. They even harm the aquatic and the terrestrial environment. Sharing of platforms and infrastructure like office spaces, etc. by mutually compatible businesses also reduces the need for creation of new ones.

Source: Mrunal 440, 441

Q.37) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** As per the data by **World Bank on Entrepreneurship**, the maximum new firms were registered in the USA, followed by Brazil and India. Hence, India is amongst the top three nations that recorded maximum registration of such firms.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** As per the data by **Economic survey 2020-21**, the maximum new firms created in India were related to the services sector followed by manufacturing and infrastructure. It also points out the importance of setting up new firms in local areas. As per the survey, a 10% increase in the registration of the firms would amount to the increase of 1.8% in the Gross District Domestic Capital.

Source: Mrunal 448, 449 and eco survey

Q.38) Ans: A

Exp:

Option A is correct: **Patent** is given for a limited period of time and is a right that is recognized within the territorial limits of the country. After the expiration of the patent period, it can be shared and be a part of the mass production process.

Evergreening of patents is a practice in which the patent holder carries out minor variations in the formula of the patents and seeks a new patent for the product thereby causing the Evergreening of the patent. **Indian Patent Act** completely prohibits the practice of Evergreening of patents. The sharing of patents or a drug formulation enables the mass production and thereby reduces its cost for the common people.

Source: Mrunal 455

Q.39) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Code on Wages, 2019** was enacted after merging the Minimum Wages Act, 1948; the Payment of Wages Act, 1936; the Payment of Bonus Act, 1965 and the Equal Remuneration Act, 1976. The Union government fixes the floor wages and the state governments are to keep the minimum wages greater or equal to the floor wages. The code provides for the deduction in the wage of the worker as penalty, due to absence or for any loans and advances, etc.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Anoop Satpathy committee** was appointed by the **Ministry of Labor and Employment** and suggested a methodology for the determination of the Minimum Wage by taking into account the minimum standard of living.

Source: Mrunal 468, 469

Q.40) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** As per the observations of the Economic Survey 2020-2021, the share of transport in the Gross value addition was 4.6% while that of the roads was around 67%. Hence, road transport was the most favored mode of transportation among the others.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The **USA** has the largest network of roads followed by India. The total length of roads in India comprising both rural and

urban, national, and state highways is 63.86 lakh km.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** According to the Survey data, more than 95% of the total volume of international trade is done via the sea route. The capacity of the ports in India have almost doubled since 2014 with significant reduction in the turnaround times of the ships.

Source: Eco survey

Q.41) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **National Electronics Policy 2019** has been introduced to make India a global hub for the Electronic Systems Designs and Manufacturing or the EDSM. It seeks to provide incentives, tax benefits and research and development in 5G, Internet of things and other high end technologies. It also seeks to create a **Sovereign Patent Fund (SDF)** where the government would buy the patents in the related technology and share it with the MSME to boost their manufacturing without them having to pay any heavy royalty.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The set clear targets to be achieved by 2025. It seeks to create 1 crore jobs and the creation of 100 crore of mobiles phone sets and exporting 60% of them.

Source: Mrunal 450

Q.42) Ans: B

Exp:

Option B is correct: The **Networked products** are those whose production occurs across a Global Value chain in multiple locations depending upon the suitability of labor cost and investments. In order to boost its exports and in turn economic growth, India needs to integrate itself to the Global value chains. The factors that enable India to benefit from this are: Improvement in infrastructure and the communication facilities so as to attract the big MultiNational Companies to set up operations in the

country. Import of the components and parts and assembly in India can increase the production which should be not just used for domestic consumption but also for the export to the other richer countries. In contrast, policies like Protectionism, which aims to safeguard opportunities and products for the local population, Lack of demographic dividend implying the increase in the population of non-working age groups, and continued political instability is likely to act as an obstacle.

Source: Mrunal

Q.43) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect: Build-operate-transfer (BOT)** model is a type of public-private partnership model in which the private player owns the infrastructure project until the expiry of the contract. The private player is responsible for the building and operation for a certain period and then transfers it to the public sector. In the **Engineering, Procurement, Construction (EPC) model** which is a kind of non-PPP model, the private partner is only responsible for the construction and it never owns it. The government is the owner of the project at all times.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect: Build-Lease-Transfer (BLT)** and the **Toll-Operate-Transfer (TOT)** is usually associated with the brownfield projects. In the first case the government gives the private player the project on lease for a certain duration to carry out its operation while in the TOT the private player pays an upfront fee to the government to operate the project for some period of time.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect: In Hybrid Annuity model**, the features of both the PPP and non-PPP are incorporated. In this model, both the government and the private player fund the infrastructure project. The private player is not entitled to the collection of the toll in this model; instead the government pays him regularly after the cost of the private player is recovered.

Source: Mrunal 624

Q.44) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** As per the data of the Economic Survey 2020-2021, India is set to become the third largest aviation market by 2025 in both domestic and international aviation. At present, India is the third largest domestic aviation market.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** There has been a remarkable improvement in the ports and shipping sector as more than 95% of India's external trade occurs via the sea route. The turn around time of the ships halved from 126.96 hours in 2015 to 61.75 hours in 2011.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** As per the observations made by the Economic survey, wireless telecommunication comprises 98.3% of the subscriber base while that of the landline is limited to just 1.7%. Hence, the wireless telecommunication has halved the subscriber base of the landline connections.

Source: Eco survey

Q.45) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** As against the earlier system of allocating license to the telecom operators with linked spectrum allocation on a first come first served basis. The present system aims at the separate application for obtaining the license and the spectrum. The spectrum is allocated separately through an auction conducted by the **Department of Telecommunication**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The telecom operators are required to pay a certain percentage of their **Adjusted Gross Revenue annually to the Government** to obtain license and as fees. There is a dispute between the government (Department of Telecommunication) and the private telecom players over the formula for the calculation of the Adjusted Gross Revenue.

Q.46) Ans: C

Exp:

Option C is correct: The **Make in India** program of the Government of India was launched in 2014 to boost the manufacturing sector of the country. It is comprised of the following targets, i.e.,

- Increase in the growth of the manufacturing sector to **12-14% of the GDP** annually,
- Increase in the **share of manufacturing sector to the GDP from 15 to 25% by 2025**,
- **Creation of 100 million jobs by 2022** in the manufacturing sector,
- Enhancement of the **competitive advantage of the Indian Industrial sector** in relation to the world,
- **creation of skills amongst the youths and the rural poor**,
- Ensure **sustainable growth that is environment friendly**. Hence, all the options given above are correct.

Q.47) Ans: D

Exp:

Option D is correct: **Industrial Revolution 1.0** was mainly ushered in the textile sector when the processes of the production were mechanized with the invention of the steam engine. It marked a stark shift from agriculture to the manufacturing sector. **Industrial Revolution 2.0** was ushered with the invention of the electricity, gas and oil that helped in the driving of the combustion engine. It revolutionized the method of transportation and communication. **Industrial Revolution 3.0** dealt with the evolution of Electronics and Information technology. It gave impetus to the field of automation and robotics. It was the **Industrial Revolution 4.0** that dealt with the ultimate digitization and made data as the raw material. It led to the creation of the virtual world that was the driving force of the physical world. Technologies like big data, Internet of things, Artificial Intelligence, Cloud computing, machine learning, etc. are the driving force of this.

Q.48) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** It was in **1972** when the **nationalization of the insurance sector** occurred during the tenure of **Indira Gandhi**. It was opened up for the private players in 2000 post the passage of Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority Act, 1999.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** In order to attract investment in the insurance sector, the foreign investment ceiling was raised from 26% to 49% under the automatic route. It is proposed to be increased to 74%. However, 100% FDI was allowed in the insurance intermediaries and brokers in February 2000.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Indian insurance market is dominated by the **Life Insurance Corporation of India**, a PSU. It covers 75% of the insurance market with the maximum contribution from the life insurance sector.

Q.49) Ans: B

Exp:

Option B is correct: The **Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan** was launched by the Government of India as part of the relief package during the COVID pandemic. It was based on the pillars of Economy, Demand, Infrastructure, System, Demography. It was different from the self-sufficiency or the isolationists model of the past that aimed at import substitution. It is focused on the promoting the capacity of the Indian economy to make it the hub of the manufacturing sector. Some notable steps to achieve this includes **disinvestment of the PSUs** wherein the participation of the private sector is ensured at each and every stage. It is aimed at **increasing Ease of Doing Business** to provide a suitable environment for the investment by the private and foreign entities. **Credit guarantee for the MSMEs** was an important part of the Atma Nirbhar Bharat initiative and aimed at protecting the MSMEs from the financial crisis suffered due to the COVID pandemic. **Networked products** is an important step in integrating India to the global supply chain due to its labor and democratic advantage. **Increasing FDI limits** in various sectors helps in the increase of investment in India and hence drives up economic growth as envisaged under the Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative.

Q.50) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Insurance Penetration is measured as the percentage of the Insurance premium to that of the GDP of the country whereas Insurance Density is measured as the ratio of the insurance premium to that of the total population.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Insurance penetration for the life insurance products was 2.82 percentage of the GDP as compared to 0.94% for the non-life products. Insurance density on the other hand was 58 USD for life insurance products as against USD 19 for the Non-life insurance products. Hence, both the premium and penetration for life insurance products is three times that of non-life insurance.

Q.51) Ans: B

Exp:

Option B is correct: In the annual session of the Indian Chamber of Commerce in 2020, the Prime Minister focused on the shift from **Command and Control** to **Plug and Play model** of the Indian economy. As per the PM, this plug and play model is aimed at easing the business environment for the private players in the country. The role of the Government in this would be to ensure adequate policy and infrastructure support in the form of land, etc. while the private sector would set up the business and begin the economic activity in an environment devoid of any delays or hurdles.

Q.52) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** As per the definition of the **Ministry of Commerce and Industry**, a start up is an entity which has been incorporated within a decade or is in operation for less than 10 years. Such an entity has annual turnover of less

than Rs. 100 crore in any financial year since its inception.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Reserve Bank of India has included Startup in the ambit of the **Priority Sector Lending**. Priority sector loans are the certain quota of loans that are extended by the commercial banks as per the guidelines of the RBI.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The startups are eligible for tax holidays for a period of three financial years consecutively out of the 10 years since its inception.

Q.53) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** There has been revision in the classification of the MSMEs. Earlier they were classified based on the investment criteria and now it has been changed to investment and turnover criteria as below:
 - **Micro enterprises**, Investment, and turnover less than 1 crore and 5 crores, respectively.
 - **Small enterprises**, Investment, and turnover less than 10 crore and 50 crores, respectively.
 - **Medium Enterprises** with investment and turnover less than 50 crore and 250 crores, respectively.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Earlier there was separate classification of the MSMEs based on the services and the manufacturing. However, this has been removed and there is currently a single classification for both the manufacturing and the services.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** In estimating the turnover of the MSMEs, the exports undertaken by them are not accounted for. This helps in greater number of entities to be added within the ambit of the MSMEs.

Q.54) Ans: A

Exp:

Option A is correct: The above terms are related to the **Technical Textiles**. Technical Textiles are textile and the related materials designed for the specific use in several domains. They fulfil certain technical and scientific functions and do not merely serve the

purpose of aesthetics. They are divided into 12 categories depending upon their usage and contribute to 0.7% of the GDP of the country. The terms like **Meditech** refers to the category of technical textiles that are used for the medical purposes like making of sanitary napkins, diapers, contact lens, etc. **Mobiltech** are those that are used for the manufacture of helmets, nylon tyres, airbags, etc. **Sportstech** is used for the production of sports related materials like swimming suits. **Oekotech** are meant for recycling, waste production, etc. **Packtechs** are used as packing materials, wrapping fabrics, jute bags, etc.

Q.55) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The **Production Linked Incentive** Schemes for the electronics provides incentives or rebates to the manufactures on the **incremental sales of the product** in relation to a base year. It is an outcome-based scheme that seeks to provide incentives only after the production has been done and also aims to ensure higher rate of growth as incentives are not provided in case of lower growths.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The production linked scheme for electronics is a **WTO compliant scheme** as the support or incentive provided in this scheme is not linked to any local value addition or the export. It focuses on the incremental sales with respect to the sale from a previous base year.

Source:

<https://www.google.co.in/amp/s/www.livemint.com/opinion/columns/productionlinked-incentives-a-well-designed-scheme/amp-11618245189412.html>

Q.56) Ans: B

Exp:

Option B is correct: The **network effect** is in common parlance in the times of digitization where the data has become the raw material for the increased production and growth for any firm. Larger the firms, more is the accessibility of the data for it and thereby more are the chances for its success. The larger data accessibility also provides greater chances for value addition. Hence, smaller firms and MSMEs are at a

disadvantage due to their small size and lack of access to the data.

Q.57) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Skills Acquisition and Knowledge Awareness for Livelihood (SANKALP)** is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme, assisted by the World Bank. SANKALP is a project to reform the skill development landscape, strengthen institutions at Central and State levels, enable greater decentralization of skill development governance, and improve industry connect of skill development programs. **Skills Strengthening for Industrial Value Enhancement (STRIVE)** project is also a World Bank assisted-Government of India project with the objective of improving the relevance and efficiency of skills training provided through Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) and apprenticeships.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **STRIVE** project aims at the improvement in the skill sets through the reform of the Industrial Training Institutes (ITI). Hence, it improves the performance of the Industrial Training Institutes (ITI) and enhances the capacity of the central and the state government to improve these institutes.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1558910>

Q.58) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC)** is a statutory body established under **The Khadi and Village Industries Commission Act, 1956** with social, economic, and overall objective of promoting the development of the Khadi and Villages industries in the rural areas.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Khadi and Village Industries Commission is a statutory body established under the **Ministry of Micro, Small, Medium Enterprises**.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Pradhan Mantri Employment Generation Program (PMEGP) is a credit linked subsidy program implemented by KVIC to generate employment opportunities by setting up employment centers. It is not a skill development program.

Source: <https://msme.gov.in/11-prime-ministers-employment-generation-programme-pmegp>

<https://www.kvic.gov.in/aboutkvic.php>

Q.59) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana (PMMY) is a scheme launched in 2015 for providing loans up to 10 lakhs to the non-corporate, non-farm small/micro enterprises given by Commercial Banks, RRBs, Small Finance Banks, MFIs and NBFCs. MUDRA is an institution to achieve this purpose.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** It is a subsidiary of **Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)**.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Shishu, Kishor and Tarun are the increasing order of limit for loan disbursal. Shishu loans have limit of **Rs 50,000 /-**, Kishor have limit **upto Rs 5 lakhs** and Tarun have limit **upto Rs 10 lakhs**.

Source: <https://udyamimitra.in/page/mudra-loans> <https://www.mudra.org.in/>

Q.60) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The **WTO negotiations** regarding E-commerce impose a permanent moratorium on the imposition of custom duties for e-commerce and electronic transmission. These negotiations are binding to the member countries. Hence, the countries party to it are bound to suffer a loss of the revenue.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** India has not signed the negotiation and has agreed to put a temporary ban on the custom duty on these services.

Q.61) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Borrower accounts should be classified as regular, SMA-0 or SMA-1 as on 29.2.2020. **Accounts classified as NPA or SMA-2 as on 29.2.2020 will not be eligible under the Scheme.** **Special Mention Accounts -0 SMA-0:** are the accounts in which the principal or the interest is due for a period of upto 30 days. **SMA-1 accounts** are those for which such a due amount is for 31-60 days while for **SMA-3**, the same limit is 61-90 days and for the NPA, the limit is more than 90 days.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Ltd [NCGTC]** is a common trustee company set up by the **Department of Financial Services, Ministry of Finance, Government of India** to, inter alia, act as a common trustee company to manage and operate various credit guarantee trust funds.

Source: <https://www.cibil.com/faq/eclgs>

Q.62) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The GoI has adopted various measures to boost tourism in India. For instance, India introduced the e-Tourist Visa regime. The government further liberalized the visa regime in 2016, renaming it to e-Visa scheme with five sub-categories i.e. 'e-Tourist Visa', 'e-Business Visa', 'e-Medical Visa', 'e-Conference Visa' and 'e-Medical Attendant Visa'. The e-Visa scheme is now available for 169 countries with valid entry through 28 designated airports and 5 designated seaports. The trend of tourist arrival in India before the arrival of Pandemic has

Table 7: Foreign and International Tourist Arrivals and Tourism Receipts in India and the World

Parameter	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
Foreign Tourist Arrivals (FTA) to India (million)	8.03	8.80	10.04	10.56	10.93

witnessed **consistent increase** as shown in the table:

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Foreign tourists from the **top 5 countries** visiting India are from **Bangladesh, USA, UK, Australia and Canada**. The top five states attracting foreign tourists are **Tamil**

Nadu, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Delhi and West Bengal

Q.63) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect:** The MSME sector contributes significantly in employment and exports in the Indian economy. In order to facilitate their growth the GOI has **changed the definition of MSME**. The new definition has increased the investment limit and turnover of MSME's. Moreover, under the new definition the **distinction between manufacturing and Services sector has been ended** and both will now be classified in the same scale.
- **Statement 2 is Correct:** Exports of goods or services or both, **shall be excluded** while calculating the turnover of any enterprise. This is done to achieve Export led growth and overcome the phenomenon of 'dwarfism' experienced in the MSME sector. Economic Survey 2019 had mentioned that Indian economy is dominated by dwarf firms that do not grow beyond their small size to get the benefits available to small sized firms.
- **Statement 3 is Correct:** An MSME can be established in the Udyog Registration portal based on self declaration with **no documentary requirements**. No fee needs to be paid for registration of MSME.

Source:

https://msme.gov.in/sites/default/files/MSME_gazette_of_india.pdf

Q.64) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect:** The **primary sector in India** (agriculture and mining sectors) contributes around **16 per cent of Gross Value Added (GVA)** while it employs around **43 per cent of the workforce** (as per PLFS, 2018-19). This indicates the huge potential to provide gainful employment opportunities for people employed in these sectors.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect:** Industry and Services are estimated to contract by 9.6 per cent and 8.8

per cent during the year. Within Industry, Mining is estimated to contract by 12.4 percent, Manufacturing by 9.4 per cent and construction by 12.6 per cent. Within the Services Sector, trade, hotels, transport & communication are estimated to contract by 21.4 per cent.

Agriculture is set to cushion the shock of the COVID-19 pandemic on the Indian economy in 2020-21 with a growth of 3.4 per cent in both Q1 and Q2. It is the only sector that has contributed positively to the overall Gross Value Added (GVA) in both Q1 and Q2 2020-21.

Source: Economic Survey

Q.65) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect:** The rules issued by the Consumer Affairs Ministry **seek to ban "specific flash sales" by e-commerce entities**. While as per the rules, conventional e-commerce flash sales are not banned, specific flash sales or back-to-back sales "which limit customer choice, increase prices and prevent a level playing field are not allowed".
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect:** Every e-commerce firm is **required to register with the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade under the Ministry of Commerce**. This will help create a database of e-commerce companies which will be displayed on the website. This will be instrumental in verifying the authenticity of e-commerce entities before making any transaction.
- **Statement 3 is Correct:** The rules have also introduced the concept of **"fall-back liability"**, which says that **e-commerce firms will be held liable** in case a seller on their platform fails to deliver goods or services due to negligent conduct, which causes loss to the customer. In several cases, when problems arise with goods purchased from their marketplaces, e-commerce platforms direct the consumers to the respective sellers to solve any grievance. With fall-back liability, consumers will be able to reach out to the platform itself.

Q.66) Ans: A

Exp:

Option A is correct:

The top services imported by India in the last 5 years are Commercial Services, Transport, other business services and Travel. An increase has been witnessed in the Transport, Telecommunication and Travel sector in the last 5 years while financial Service imports have shown a decline.

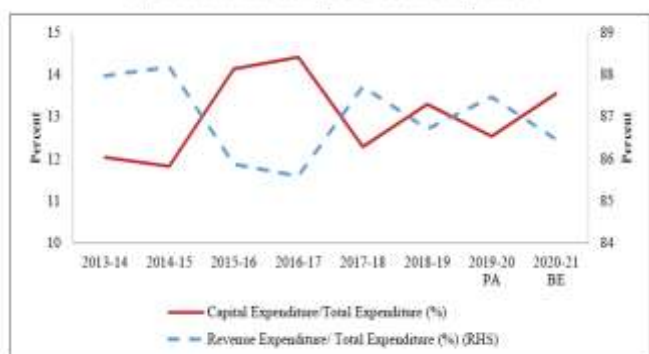
Source: https://www.tpci.in/research_report/india-services-trade/

Q.67) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect:** Tax-to-GDP ratio represents the size of a country's tax relative to its GDP. It is a representation of the size of the government's tax revenue expressed as a percentage of the GDP. Higher the tax to GDP ratio the better the financial position of the country. **Tax to GDP ratio of India** increased from 10% to 16% during the period from 1965 to 1990. However it has **hovered around 16-17 % ever since LPG reforms.**
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect:** On the expenditure front, Budget 2020-21 estimated total expenditure at 30.42 lakh crore, comprising revenue expenditure of 26.3 lakh crore and capital expenditure of 4.12 lakh crore, which work out to be 11.7 per cent and 1.7 per cent of GDP, respectively. The trend in the components of total expenditure are given as follows;

Figure 13: Trends in components of Total Expenditure



Source: Union Budget Documents & CGA

Reference:

Source; Economic survey

Q.68) Ans:B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect:** Intellectual Property Appellate Board, a **statutory body** established under the provisions of the **Trade Marks Act, 1999**. It hears appeals against the decisions of the Registrar of TradeMarks and Geographical Indications and Controller of Patents.

- **Statement 2 is Correct:** It is **headquartered in Chennai** and seatings also take place in Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata and Ahmedabad. It is under the **control of the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**, Ministry of commerce.
- **Statement 3 is Correct:** A strong IPR regime could also influence the inflows of FDI, technology transfers and trade that may have a bearing on the growth of the country. Hence, a strengthened IPAB will certainly directly contribute to the growth of a stronger IPR regime and indirectly in the growth of economic development.

Source: <https://www.ipab.gov.in/about.php>

<https://dipp.gov.in/programmes-and-schemes/intellectual-property-rights/scheme-strengthening-intellectual-property-appellate-board-ipab>

Q.69) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Option 1 is correct:** Transfer payments are the receipts which the residents of a country get for free without having to pay for any goods or services. They Include migrants' transfers by way of remittances for family maintenance, repatriation of savings and transfer of financial and real resources linked to change in resident status of migrants.
- **Option 2 is Incorrect:** Transfers payments represent one-sided transactions, i.e., transactions that do not have any quid pro quo,. Since payments have to be made for the imported material, it does not form the part of Transfer payments.
- **Option 3 is correct:** Official transfer receipts record grants, donations and other assistance received by the Government from bilateral and multilateral institutions. Similar transfers by Indian Government to other countries are recorded under official transfer payments.

Source: NCERT

Q.70) Ans: D

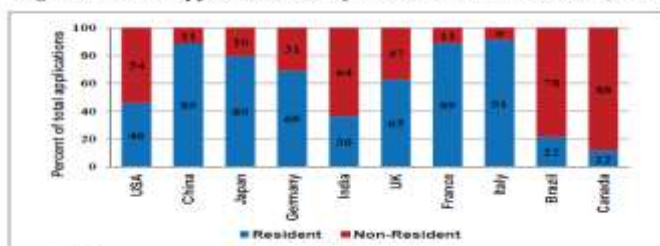
Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect:** The economic Survey 2020-2021 noted that the government does the heavy lifting on R&D and there is a need for

businesses to contribute more to the sector. The survey noted India's business sector needs to rise to the occasion and significantly ramp up its gross expenditure on R&D. This requires boosting the business sector contribution to total GERD from **37 percent currently to 68 percent** — the average business contribution in GERD of other top 10 economies.

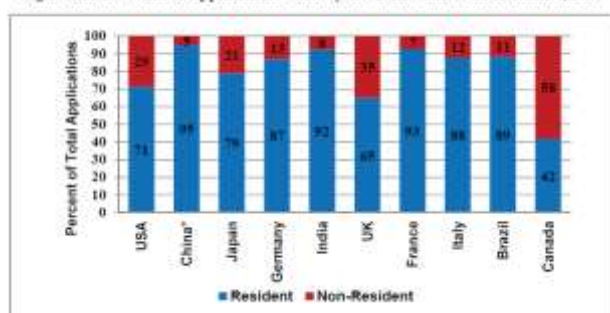
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect:** The total number of patents filed in India has risen steeply since 1999, mainly on account of increase in **patent applications filed by non-residents**. While patent applications filed by residents have increased steadily since 1999, they have risen at a much lower rate than patent applications by non-residents. Unlike patents, the total number of **trademark** applications filed in India has risen steeply since 1999 mainly on account of increase in trademark **applications filed by residents**. The comparison of Patent and trademarks by residents and non-residents are:

Figure 39: Patent Applications Filed by Residents and Non-Residents, 2019



Source: WIPO

Figure 41: Trademark Applications Filed by Residents and Non-Residents, 2019



Extra Edge by OnlyIAS: India's gross expenditure on R&D is **0.65 per cent** of its gross domestic product (GDP), significantly lower than the **1.5-3 percent of GDP spent by the top 10 economies**. It remains low despite the Centre's higher contribution to GERD (gross domestic expenditure on R&D).

Sources: <https://www.business-standard.com/article/economy-policy/no-jugaad->

[businesses-must-raise-r-d-spend-says-economic-survey-121013000063_1.html](https://www.business-standard.com/article/economy-policy/no-jugaad-)

Q.71) Ans: A

Exp:

'eSagu':

- It is a **web-based personalized agro-advisory system** which uses Information Technology to solve unscientific agricultural practices.
- Sagu means cultivation in the Telugu-local language of Telangana and Andhra Pradesh.
- E-Sagu means electronic cultivation. It exploits the advances in Information Technology to build a cost-effective agricultural information dissemination system to disseminate expert agriculture knowledge to the farming community to improve crop productivity.
- It is a joint research project of Media lab asia and IIIT Hyderabad.

Source: Wikipedia

Q.72) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect :** Recently , the **Ministry of coal constituted a Task force and Expert committee to prepare a road map for coal-based hydrogen production (Black Hydrogen)**. The Expert Committee is set up under the chairmanship of Shri R.K. Malhotra. This is aimed for contributing to the agenda of a hydrogen-based economy in a clean manner. On India's 75 th Independence Day, the Prime Minister announced a Hydrogen Mission.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Cost of Hydrogen produced from coal can be cheaper and less sensitive to imports** when compared with hydrogen production through electrolysis and Natural Gas respectively.
 - Coal is one of the important sources of hydrogen making apart from Natural Gas and renewable energy through electrolysis. In the case of renewable energy (Green Hydrogen) surplus solar power is used to electrolyze water into hydrogen and oxygen.
 - The global emphasis is on substituting liquid fuels with hydrogen (as fuel in vehicles), storage of surplus renewable

power as hydrogen (as power cannot be stored at a cost effective price), and cutting down emission.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect** : It can be stored physically in gas and liquid form as well. Production of hydrogen from coal will have challenges in terms of high emissions and CCUS will play an important role. However, when the carbon monoxide and carbon dioxide formed during the coal to hydrogen process are trapped and stored in an environmentally sustainable manner (CCS and CCUS), then, Indian coal reserves could become a great source of hydrogen.

Source :

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1752915>

Q.73) Ans: C

Exp:

'Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission'

- It is a National Digital Health Ecosystem that **supports Universal Health Coverage** in an efficient, accessible, inclusive, affordable, timely, and safe manner, through provision of a wide-range of data, information and infrastructure services.
- It **will connect the digital health solutions of hospitals across the country with each other**. The Digital Ecosystem will also enable a host of other facilities like Digital Consultation, Consent of patients in letting medical practitioners access their records, etc. With the implementation of this scheme, old medical records cannot get lost as every record will be stored digitally.
- The scheme will come under the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana.
- It comprises six key building blocks — HealthID, DigiDoctor, Health Facility Registry, Personal Health Records, e-Pharmacy and Telemedicine.
- The **National Health Authority** has been given the mandate to **design, build, roll-out and implement the mission in the country**.
- The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission was piloted successfully for one year in the six Union Territories:
 - Andaman & Nicobar Islands
 - Chandigarh
 - Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu
 - Ladakh

- Lakshadweep
- Puducherry

Source :

<https://www.india.gov.in/spotlight/ayushman-bharat-digital-mission-abdm>

Q.74) Ans: A

Exp:

Meenakari Painting

- It is the process of **painting and colouring the surfaces of metals and ceramic tiles** through enameling. It is practiced as an art form and commercially produced mainly in Iran, Afghanistan, Pakistan and India.
- Minakari art usually involves intricate designs (mainly using geometric shapes and designs) and is applied as a decorative feature to serving dishes, containers, vases, frames, display ornaments and jewelry.
- It **originated in Safavid, Iran and was introduced to India by the Mughal**. The Moghuls introduced it into India and perfected the technique, making the design applied on objects more intricate.
- The term 'Kundan' is more widely used in India for this painting.
- In India, Rajasthan and Gujarat are most famous for their Mīnākārī artifacts and jewelry.



Source : Wikipedia

Q.75) Ans: A

Exp:

Judima Rice wine

- A **home-made rice wine of Assam's Dimasa tribe** has become the first traditional brew in all of the northeast to bag a Geographical Indication (GI) tag.
- It is **made from sticky rice, which is steamed and mixed with traditional herbs like named thembra**. **Judima derives its name from ju which means wine and Dima means 'belonging to the Dimasa'**. It is a pale yellow or reddish (depending on the colour of rice) drink that is slightly cloudy in appearance, has a mellow fragrance and is sweet to taste.

- It is made from three different types of saul (rice): red or white bora (the glutinous sticky variety), non-bora (the everyday non-sticky variety) and finally the bairing rice, a unique variety cultivated in Jhum style (terrace farming) only by the Dimasa people.
 - Bairing rice is cultivated solely for preparing Judima.** Bairing is not a fine variety of rice. So it is not consumed as food.
- For the Dimasa people, judima is an important part of their tradition, to be used in ceremonies that celebrate birth and mourn death. Of late, the drink is also offered to guests or simply enjoyed at home to call it a day.

Extra Edge by OnlyIAS

GI Tagged Products from Assam:

- Kaji Nemu (a type of lemon) (2020)
- Chokuwa Rice of Assam (2019)

About GI Tag :

- A GI tag is awarded to products associated with a **specific geographical origin**.
- Awarding a GI sign not only helps in tracing the origins of products but also helps in confirming authenticity and marketing of indigenous specialities.
- It is also a **part of the World Trade Organisation's Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS)**.
- GI tag in India is **governed by the Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration & Protection) Act, 1999**. It is issued by the Geographical Indications Registry (Chennai).
- The registration of a geographical indication is valid for a **period of 10 years**.
- Manipur's Tamenglong orange and Hathei chilli, grown in the hill districts of Tamenglong and Ukhrul, respectively, and Mizoram's ginger were accorded the GI tag.

Source : <https://fantasycricket.hindustantimes>

Q.76) Ans: A

Exp:

- Statement 1 is incorrect:** International Labour Organization became a **specialized agency of the United Nations** in 1946. It is a tripartite organization, the only one of its kind bringing together **representatives of governments, employers and workers** in its executive bodies. It

is the United Nations agency for the **world of work**. It is also a member of the United Nations Development Group (UNDP). Headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland.

- Statement 2 is correct:** It sets international labour standards, **promotes rights at work and encourages decent employment opportunities**, the enhancement of social protection and the strengthening of dialogue on work-related issues.
- Statement 3 is incorrect:** **India** is a **founding member of the ILO** with a total **187 member States**. In **2020 India assumed the Chairmanship** of the Governing Body of ILO. The Chairperson of the Governing Body of ILO is a position of international repute. The Governing Body (GB) is the apex executive body of the ILO. India has been a **permanent member of the ILO** Governing Body since 1922. The first ILO Office in India started in 1928. India has ratified **41 Conventions of the ILO**, which is much better than the position existing in many other countries.
- Statement 4 is correct:** The Global Wage Report is published by the **International Labour Organization**, which examines the evolution of real wages around the world, giving a unique picture of wage trends globally and by region. In 1969, ILO received the **Nobel Peace Prize** for improving fraternity and peace among nations, pursuing decent work and justice for workers, and providing technical assistance to other developing nations.

Reference: <https://www.ilo.org/global/about-the-ilo/lang--en/index.htm>

Q.77) Ans: B

Exp:

I-Familia :

- I-Familia is a **global database** launched to **identify missing persons through family DNA**. It will help the police to solve cases in member countries.
- Interpol** applies cutting-edge scientific research and uses the **DNA of relatives** to identify missing persons or unidentified human remains around the world. DNA kinship matching is used mostly in cases where a direct sample of the missing person is not available.
- I-Familia has **three components**:
 - Dedicated global database to host the DNA profiles** provided by relatives. It is held separately from any criminal data,

- **DNA matching software** called Bonaparte developed by Dutch company Smart Research and
- **Interpretation guidelines** developed by Interpol.
- **Interpol:** The International Criminal Police Organization (Interpol) is an **intergovernmental organization** that helps coordinate the police force of 194 member countries. Each of the member countries hosts an Interpol **National Central Bureau (NCB)**. This connects their national law enforcement with other countries and with the General Secretariat. The **Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)** is designated as the National Central Bureau of India. It is headquartered in **Lyon, France**.

Reference: <https://www.interpol.int/en/How-we-work/Forensics/I-Familia>

Q.78) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Seed Minikit Programme is launched by the Ministry of Agriculture. Seed Minikit Programme aims to **distribute high yielding varieties of seeds of pulses and oilseeds to farmers**. The programme is wholly funded by the Center through the National Food Security Mission. The seed mini-kits are being provided by the following central agencies – National Seeds Corporation(NCS), NAFED and Gujarat State Seeds Corporation.
- This programme is a major tool for introducing **new varieties of seeds** in fields. It will also help in increasing the seed replacement rate. Under the mission distribution of seeds will continue till June 15, 2021. Thus, farmers will get seeds before commencement of Kharif sowing season.
- **Statement 2 is correct :** Horticulture development is a **central sector programme** aimed at growing and developing identified horticulture clusters to make them globally competitive. Horticulture cluster is a regional/ geographical concentration of targeted horticulture crops. The nodal agency for the programme will be the **National Horticulture Board(NHB)**.
- The objective of the programme is to address all major issues related to the Indian horticulture sector including **pre-production, production, post-harvest management, logistics, marketing and branding**. The programme will benefit about

10 lakh farmers and is expected to attract an investment of Rs. 10,000 crore when implemented in all the 53 clusters.

Reference:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1723864>

Q.79) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Konark temple is a **World Heritage Site** is situated in the eastern state of Odisha and is a massive temple dedicated to the Sun God temple. It was considered as a chariot for the Sun God, the word '**Konark**' is a combination of two words 'Kona' and 'Arka'. 'Kona' means '**Corner**' and 'Arka' means '**Sun**', so when combined it becomes '**Sun of the Corner**'.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It is also known as the **Black Pagoda** which was built in the middle of the 13th century in black granite during the reign of **Narasimhadeva-I** the great ruler of the Ganga dynasty. The Konark Temple was designed in the form of a gorgeously decorated chariot mounted on 24 wheels, each about 10 feet in diameter, and drawn by 7 mighty horses. It is protected under the National Framework of India by the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains (AMASR) Act (1958) and its Rules (1959).
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Lingaraja Temple is a **Hindu temple dedicated to Shiva** and is one of the **oldest temples in Bhubaneswar**. The Lingaraja temple is the largest temple in Bhubaneswar. The temple represents the quintessence of the **Kalinga architecture**.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The Lingaraj temple is believed to be built by the kings from the **Somavamsi dynasty**, with later additions from the Ganga rulers. Lingaraj is referred to as '**Swayambhu**' – self-originated Shivaling. Another important aspect of the temple is that it signifies the syncretisation of **Shaivism and Vaishnavism sects in Odisha**. Perhaps the rising cult of **Lord Jagannath** (considered an incarnation of Lord Vishnu) which coincided with the completion of the Lingaraja Temple had a role to play. The presiding deity in the Temple is known as **Hari-Hara**; Hari denotes Lord Vishnu and Hara meaning Lord Shiva.

Reference: Nitin Singhania

Q.80) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** TRIFOOD is a joint initiative of **TRIFED** (under the Ministry of Tribal Affairs) and the **Ministry of Food Processing**. It was launched under the Van Dhan Yojana in 2020. This scheme promotes **entrepreneurship among tribals** by providing them with a comprehensive development package.
- TRIFED and the Ministry of Tribal Affairs will ensure that the sales proceeds of the value added products directly goes to tribals without any intermediaries.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect :** TRIFOOD Parks are food processing centres aiming at promoting value addition to **minor forest produce**. It will improve the tribal ecosystem and will inculcate a feeling of Confidence among them. Value of food items procured would be well processed before final sale, generating more profits for the Industries attached. It will **remove the middlemen** who are the major source for corruption, and the miserable lives of Tribals. It will generate more revenue for the government as the products exported will be of high quality.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The parks procure raw materials from the **Van Dhan Kendras** and process them to be sold across the country through Tribes India outlets. The minimum support price for minor forest produce is fixed by the **Tribal Affairs Ministry** and it is revised every three years by a pricing cell constituted under the Ministry.

Extra edge by Only IAS

Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India (TRIFED)

- It is a **statutory body** and was established in August 1987.
- It has been registered as a National level Cooperative body by the Government of the country Focus is on institutionalising the trade of Minor Forest Produce (MFP) & Surplus Agricultural Produce (SAP) collected/ cultivated by them.
- TRIFED helps tribal people manufacture products for national and international markets on a sustainable basis.
- The mandate of TRIFED is to enhance socio economic development of tribals by institutionalization of minor forest produce (MFP) and surplus agricultural produce

trade.

Reference: <https://trifed.tribal.gov.in/trifood>

Q.81) Ans: D

Exp:

Mura-Drava-Danube Biosphere Reserve

- UNESCO has designated the world's first biosphere to span across five different countries- and they're all in Europe.
- The new biosphere reserve covers an area of 700km and includes parts of **Austria, Slovenia, Croatia, Hungary and Serbia**.
- The basis of the biosphere is a route along the Mura, Drava and Danube rivers that wind through these five European nations.
- The basis of the biosphere is a route along the Mura, Drava and Danube rivers that pass through these five European nations.
- It is dubbed the '**Amazon of Europe**', the biosphere is a multinational effort to curb ecological destruction. It is the largest river-based protected area in the entirety of Europe.

Source:

<https://www.euronews.com/green/amp/2021/09/16/amazon-of-europe-is-first-unesco-biosphere-to-cover-five-nations>

Q.82) Ans: D

Exp:

Hybodont Shark

- Recently, The Geological Survey of India (GSI) and the Indian Institute of Technology, Roorkee have discovered a **new extinct species of hybodont shark from the Jaisalmer Basin of Rajasthan**.
- These sharks have been reported for the first time from Jurassic rocks (approximately, between 160 and 168 million-years-old).
- **Hybodonts dominated both marine and freshwater environments** during the Triassic and early Jurassic periods.
- Hybodont sharks started to decline in marine environments from the Middle Jurassic onwards until they formed a relatively minor component of open-marine shark assemblages.
- They finally became extinct at the end of the Cretaceous time 65 million years ago.
- During the Triassic, Jurassic, and Cretaceous periods, the hybodonts were especially found in shallow seas across the world.

Source

<https://www.livemint.com/science/news/rare-discovery-new-species-of-extinct-shark-hybodont-of-jurassic-age-found-in-rajasthan-s-jaisalmer/amp-11631705488965.html>

Q.83) Ans: C

Exp:

Dugong Conservation Reserve

- Recently, **Tamil Nadu state has India's first dugong conservation reserve**. It is 500 sq.km of biodiversity-rich waters in the Palk Bay, on the southeast coast of Tamil Nadu.
- This conservation reserve spreads the northern part of the Palk Bay from Adirampattinam to Amapattinam.

About Dugong

- The dugong, also called the **sea cow**, is a **herbivorous** mammal. They can grow upto three meters long, weigh about 300 kilograms, and live for about 65 to 70 years, grazing on seagrass and coming to the surface to breathe.
- They are found in over 30 countries and in India are seen in the **Gulf of Mannar, Gulf of Kutch, Palk Bay, and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands**.
- Dugongs are included in Schedule I of the wildlife protection Act, 1972, which affords it the highest degree of protection under the Act.
- Dugongs are listed as **Vulnerable** on the IUCN Red List of Threatened Species and are listed in **Appendix I** of the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES), which prohibits the trade of the species and its parts.
- Dugongs are threatened by sea grass habitat loss or degradation because of coastal development or industrial activities that cause water pollution. They also often become **victims of bycatch**, the accidental entanglement in fishing nets.

Source :

<https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/tamil-nadu/2021/sep/04/indias-1st-dugong-conservation-reserve-to-be-in-tn-2354056.amp>

Q.84) Ans: C

Exp:

- Statement 1 is correct : Energy Return on Investment (EROI) is a ratio for describing a measure of energy produced in relation to the energy used to create it.** It is the amount of

energy expended to produce a certain amount of net energy.

- Statement 2 is correct :** EROI is an important determinant in energy commodity and electricity pricing. EROI decreases when energy becomes scarcer and more difficult to extract or produce. EROI can also help organizations and governments compare different energy sources for profitability, such as nuclear vs. solar power. When the EROI is large, that means that producing energy from that source is relatively easy and cost-effective. When the number is small then obtaining energy from that source is difficult and expensive. For example, when the ratio is 1, there is no return on energy invested.

Source :

<https://www.investopedia.com/terms/g/green-investing.asp>

Q.85) Ans: D

Exp:

About Green Building

- A 'green' building is a building that, in its design, construction or operation, reduces or eliminates negative impacts, and can create positive impacts, on our climate and natural environment. Green buildings preserve precious natural resources and improve our quality of life.
- Green buildings depend on the sun, wind, and geothermal energy so there is reduced dependence on conventional sources of energy. *This reduces the carbon footprint.*
- There are a number of features which can make a building 'green'. These include:
 - Efficient use of energy, water and other resources.
 - Use of renewable energy, such as solar energy.
 - Pollution and waste reduction measures, and the enabling of re-use and recycling.
 - Good indoor environmental air quality.
 - Use of materials that are non-toxic, ethical and sustainable.
 - Consideration of the environment in design, construction and operation.
 - Consideration of the quality of life of occupants in design, construction and operation.
 - A design that enables adaptation to a changing environment.

Source : <https://www.worldgbc.org/what-green-building>

Q.86) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statements 1 and 3 are correct :** Green investing consists of investment activities that focus on companies or projects committed to the conservation of natural resources. Green investing seeks to support business practices that have a favorable impact on the natural environment, such as conservation of natural resources, pollution reduction, or other environmentally-conscious business practices. Some investors buy green bonds, green ETFs, green index funds, green mutual funds, or hold stock in environmentally-friendly companies to support green initiatives.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect :** Profit is not the only motive for investors, Green investing may mimic or beat the returns of more traditional assets. Pure-play green investments are investments in which most or all revenues come from green activities.

Extra Edge by OnlyIAS

Few types of 'Green Investment'

Green Equities:

- It is a form of green investing to buy stock in companies with strong environmental commitments.

Green Bonds:

- Sometimes known as climate bonds, these fixed-income securities represent loans to help banks, companies, and government bodies finance projects with a positive impact on the environment.

Green Fund:

- It is to invest in shares of a mutual fund, or index fund that provides wider exposure to green companies. These green funds invest in a basket of promising securities, allowing investors to spread their money on a diversified range of environmental projects.

Source :

<https://www.investopedia.com/terms/g/green-investing.asp>

Q.87) Ans: C

Exp :

- **Statement 1 is correct :** Renewable Energy Certificates (RECs) are a market-based instrument that certifies the bearer owns one megawatt-hour (MWh) of electricity generated from a renewable energy resource. Renewable Energy Certificates are recognised by other names such as Green Tags, Tradable Renewable Certificates (TRCs), Renewable Electricity Certificates, or Renewable Energy Credits.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect :** Renewable Energy Certificates can be sold on the open market as an energy commodity. Once the power provider has fed the energy into the grid, the REC received can then be sold on the open market as an energy commodity.
- **Statement 3 is correct :** Renewable Energy Certificate (REC) acts as an accounting or tracking mechanism for solar, wind, and other green energies The price of RECs is determined by market demand and specified by the Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC).
- Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC), statutory body under the Ministry of Power, has notified the Regulation on Renewable Energy Certificate (REC) in fulfillment of its mandate to promote renewable sources of energy and development of markets in electricity.

Source :

<https://www.investopedia.com/terms/g/green-investing.asp>

Q.88) Ans: B

Exp:

"Mapping India's Climate Vulnerability – A District-level Assessment"

- Recently, a report titled **"Mapping India's Climate Vulnerability – A District-level Assessment"** was released by the **Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW) (not-for-profit policy research institution).**
- The report has also launched the first-of-its-kind Climate Vulnerability Index. The index has analysed 640 districts in India and found that 463 of these are vulnerable to extreme floods, droughts and cyclones.

Highlights of the report :

- *More than 80 percent of India's population lives in districts highly vulnerable to extreme hydro-met disasters.*

- The southern zone of India is the most vulnerable to extreme climate events and their compounding impacts, followed by the eastern, western, northern, north-eastern and central zones.
- 59 and 41 per cent of the total districts in the eastern and western zones of India are highly vulnerable to extreme cyclone events.
- The states located in India's northeast are more vulnerable to floods, while the states in the southern and central parts are more vulnerable to extreme droughts.

Source : <https://www.ceew.in/publications/mapping-climate-change-vulnerability-index-of-india-a-district-level-assessment>

Q.89) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect-** World sustainable development summit is the annual flagship event that is organised by the Energy and Resources Institute (TERI). The summit will be organised with the aim to bring together a wide number of governments, academicians, business leaders, climate scientists, civil society and youth to fight against climate change.
- **Statement 2 is correct-** The theme of the Summit is 'Redefining our common future: Safe and secure environment for all'. The summit will hold discussions on the topics ranging from Climate finance, circular economy, Energy & industry transition, adaptation & resilience, nature-based solutions, clean oceans and air pollution.
- The key partners of the summit are the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy, the Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change and the Ministry of Earth Sciences. The summit is organised in accordance with the adoption of the Sustainable Development Goals and the Paris Agreement.

Extra edge by Onlyias

The Energy and Resources Institute(TERI)

- It is a non-profit research institute. It was established in 1974 as Tata Energy Research Institute and renamed to The Energy Resources Institute in 2003.
- Purpose - It conducts research work in the fields of energy, environment, and sustainable development for India and the Global South.
- Headquarter-New Delhi.

Other Initiatives by TERI:

- Lightning a billion lives (LaBL)
- Green Olympiad
- Green rating of integrated habitat assessment (GRIHA)

Reference: <https://www.teriin.org/press-release/act-together-support-innovation-pm-modi-calls-upon-every-country-think-greater-good>

Q.90) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The GCF was set up in 2010 under the UNFCCC's financial mechanism to channel funding from **developed countries** to **developing countries** to allow them to mitigate climate change and also adapt to disruptions arising from a changing climate. The Fund will strive to **maximize the impact of its funding for adaptation and mitigation**, and seek a balance between the two, while promoting environmental, social, economic and development co-benefits and taking a gender-sensitive approach.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Green climate fund was established under the **Cancun Agreement in 2010 by UNFCCC** as a dedicated financing vehicle for developing countries within the global climate architecture. It is serving as the **Financial Mechanism of the UNFCCC and the Paris Agreement**

Reference: <https://www.greenclimate.fund/about>

Q.91) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Stockholm Convention:** It is a global treaty to **protect human health and environment from POPs**, which are identified chemical substances that persist in the environment, bio-accumulate in living organisms, adversely affect human health/ environment and have the property of long-range environmental transport (LRET).
- **The provisions of the Convention require each party to:**
 - Prohibit and/or eliminate the production and use, as well as the import and export, of the intentionally, produced POPs that are listed in Annex A to the Convention.
 - Restrict the production and use, as well as the import and export, of the intentionally, produced POPs that are listed in Annex B to the Convention.

- Reduce or eliminate releases from unintentionally produced POPs that are listed in Annex C to the Convention.
- Ensure that stockpiles and wastes consisting of, containing or contaminated with POPs are managed safely and in an environmentally sound manner.
- Persistent organic pollutants (POPs), sometimes known as “**forever chemicals**” are organic compounds that are resistant to environmental degradation through chemical, biological, and photolytic processes. Because of their persistence, POPs bioaccumulate with potential adverse impacts on human health and the environment.

Reference: <http://www.pops.int/>

Q.92) Ans: B

Exp:

- **About Eutrophication:** The **nutrient-enrichment** of the lakes promotes the growth of algae, aquatic plants and various fauna. This process is known as **natural eutrophication**. Similar nutrient enrichment of lakes at an accelerated rate is caused by **human activities and the consequent ageing phenomenon is known as cultural eutrophication**.
- Eutrophication is the response to the addition of nutrients such as **nitrates and phosphates naturally or artificially**, fertilising the aquatic ecosystem.
- **Phytoplankton** (algae and blue-green bacteria) thrive on the excess nutrients and their population explosion covers almost the entire surface layer. This condition is known as algal bloom.
- Eutrophication eventually creates a detritus layer in lakes and produces successively shallower depth of surface water. Eventually, the water body is reduced into a marsh whose plant community is transformed from an aquatic environment to a recognizable terrestrial environment.

Reference: Shankar IAS,

Q.93) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The carbon credit system is a **by-product of Kyoto protocol**. A carbon credit (often called a carbon offset) is a **tradable certificate or permit**. One carbon credit is equal to one tonne of carbon dioxide. Carbon credits or

carbon offsets can be acquired through afforestation, renewable energy, CO2 sequestration, methane capture, buying from an exchange (carbon credits trading) etc.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Carbon trading is the name given to the exchange of emission permits. This **exchange may take place within the economy** or may take the form of an **international transaction**. Under Carbon Credits Trading mechanism countries that emit more carbon than the quota allotted to them buy carbon credits from those that emit less. In Carbon trading, one credit gives the country or a company the right to emit one tonne of CO2.

Reference:

https://www.investopedia.com/terms/c/carbon_credit.asp

Q.94) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Ethanol Blending :** It is motor fuel containing ethyl alcohol that is at least 99% pure, derived from agricultural products, and blended exclusively with petrol.
- **Ethanol:** Ethanol is one of the principal biofuels, which is naturally produced by the fermentation of sugars by yeasts or via petrochemical processes such as ethylene hydration.
- Ethanol also has *medical applications as an antiseptic and disinfectant*. It is used as a *chemical solvent and in the synthesis of organic compounds*.
- The ethanol blending **gives extra income to farmers** because ethanol is derived from sugarcane and also foodgrains. Hence, farmers can earn extra income by selling their surplus produce to ethanol blend manufacturers.

Extra Edge by OnlyIAS

- The Ethanol Blended Petrol Programme was launched in 2003.
- The main objective of the program was to **promote the use of renewable and environmentally friendly fuels and reduce India's import dependence for energy security**.
- In this initiative, The government started with 5% blending, and has set a target of **10% ethanol blending by 2022 and 20% blending (E20) by 2030**.
- The programme is implemented in accordance with the **National Policy on Biofuels**.

- Under this programme, oil marketing companies (OMCs) will procure ethanol from domestic sources at prices fixed by the government.
- Till 2018, only sugarcane was used to derive ethanol. Now, the government has extended the ambit of the program to include food grains like maize, bajra, fruit and vegetable waste, etc. to produce ethanol.

Source :

https://m.economictimes.com/news/economy/policy/indias-plans-for-20-ethanol-blending-will-cut-sugar-subsidy-oil-secretary/amp_articleshow/87645114.cms

Q.95) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Both Statements are correct:** Blue carbon is the carbon stored in coastal and marine ecosystems. The coastal ecosystems of mangroves, tidal marshes and seagrass meadows contain large stores of carbon deposited by vegetation and various natural processes.
- These ecosystems sequester and store more carbon – often referred to as ‘blue carbon’ – per unit area than terrestrial forests.
- These ecosystems also provide essential benefits for climate change adaptation, including coastal protection and food security for many coastal communities.
- *The ability of these vegetated ecosystems to remove carbon dioxide (CO₂) from the atmosphere makes them significant net carbon sinks.*

Extra Edge by Only IAS

- **Brown Carbon:** It is brown smoke released by the combustion of organic matter.
- **Black Carbon:** It is also a greenhouse gas and causes more pollution than Brown Carbon. The particles leftover from incomplete combustion of fossil fuels (soot and dust). It has a greater effect on radiation transmission.
- **Green Carbon:** Carbon incorporated into plant biomass and the soils below. Green carbon is carbon removed by photosynthesis and stored in the plants and soil of natural ecosystems.

Source : <https://www.iucn.org/resources/issues-briefs/blue-carbon>

Q.96) Ans: D

Exp:

About Abanindranath Tagore:

- Abanindranath Tagore's 150th birth anniversary was celebrated on 7th August 2021.
- He along with his brother Gaganendranath Tagore founded 'Indian Society of Oriental Art' in 1907.
- He was also the first major exponent of Swadeshi values in Indian art, thereby finding the influential Bengal school of art, which led to the development of modern Indian painting
- **His famous paintings:** Bharat Mata (1905), The Passing of Shah Jahan (1900), Tales of Arabian Nights (1928).

Extra Edge by OnlyIAS

About M.F Hussain:

- He was known for executing bold, vibrantly coloured narrative paintings in a **modified Cubist style**.
- He was one of the founding members of **Bombay Progressive Artists' Group**.

About Raja Ravi Varma:

- He is considered the **first of the modernists**, and he advocated for the use of Western techniques to **develop a new aesthetic** in the subjective interpretation of Indian culture.
- His work was considered to be among the **best examples of the fusion of Indian traditions** with the techniques of European academic art, and it came to play an important role in the development of the Indian national consciousness.
- Paintings: Depicting episodes from the story of **Dushyanta and Shakuntala, and Nala and Damayanti, from the Mahabharata**.

About Nandalal Bose:

- A pupil of Abanindranath Tagore, Bose was known for his "**Indian style**" of painting. He became the principal of Kala Bhavan, Santiniketan in 1922.

Reference:

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/other-states/celebrations-begin-to-mark-150-years-of-iconic-artist-abanindranath-tagore/article35766597.ece>

Q.97) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Preventive detention must fall within the four corners of **Article 21 (due process of law)** read with **Article 22 (safeguards)**

against arbitrary arrest and detention) and the statute in question, Justice Nariman said. **Article 20** talks about Protection in Respect of Conviction for Offences.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect: Article 22 (2)** : Every person who is arrested and detained in custody shall be produced before the nearest magistrate within a period of **twenty-four hours of such arrest excluding the time** necessary for the journey from the place of arrest to the court of the magistrate and no such person shall be detained in custody beyond the said period without the authority of a magistrate.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The 44th Amendment Act of 1978 has **reduced the period** of detention without obtaining the opinion of an advisory board from **three to two months**. However, this provision has not yet been brought into force, hence, the original period of three months still continues.

Reference:

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/preventive-detention-a-necessary-evil-only-to-prevent-public-disorder-supreme-court/article35688565.ece>

Inspiration: UPSC 2021 questions on Parole, Police custody

Q.98) Ans: C

Exp:

About Project REPLAN:

- **Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC)** has secured Patent registration for its innovative **Plastic-mixed Handmade Paper** developed to reduce plastic menace from nature. The patent certificate was issued to KVIC's Kumarappa National Handmade Paper Institute (KNHPI), Jaipur, on 2nd August 2021, by the Controller of Patent, Intellectual Property of India.
- The plastic-mixed handmade paper was developed under **KVIC's Project REPLAN (REducing PLastic from Nature)**. This is the first of its kind project in India, where plastic waste is de-structured, degraded, diluted and used with paper pulp while making handmade paper and thus reduces plastic waste from nature.

Extra Edge by OnlyIAS

About KVIC:

- Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) is a **statutory body** established by an Act of Parliament under Ministry of **MSME**.

- It took over the work of the former All India Khadi and Village Industries Board.
- The **broad objectives that the KVIC** has set before it are-
 - The social objective of providing employment.
 - The economic objective of producing saleable articles.
 - The wider objective of creating self-reliance amongst the poor and building up a strong rural community spirit.

Reference:

<https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1742710>

Inspiration: UPSC PYQs focus on new advancements in renewable energies. Ex: H-CNG 2019

Q.99) Ans: C

Exp:

About SUGAR PRICING POLICY:

- Prices of sugar are market driven & depend on demand & supply of sugar. However, with a view to protect the interests of farmers, **concept of Minimum Selling Price (MSP) of sugar has been introduced w.e.f. 07.06.2018** so that industry may get atleast the minimum cost of production of sugar, so as to enable them to clear cane price dues of farmers
- **Statement 1 is correct:** In exercise of the powers conferred by **Essential Commodities Act, 1955**, Government has notified Sugar Price (Control) Order, 2018. Under the provisions of said order, **Government initially fixed Minimum Selling Price (MSP) of white/refined sugar at Rs. 29/kg w.e.f. 07.06.2018** for sale by sugar mills at the factory gate for domestic consumption, which has been revised from Rs.29/kg to Rs.31/kg w.e.f. 14.02.2019.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** MSP of sugar has been fixed after taking into account the Fair & Remunerative Price (FRP) of sugarcane and minimum conversion cost of the **most efficient mills**.

About SUGARCANE PRICING POLICY:

- **Statement 3 is correct:** With the amendment of the Sugarcane (Control) Order, 1966 on 22.10.2009, the concept of Statutory Minimum Price (SMP) of sugarcane was replaced with the

‘Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP)’ of sugarcane for 2009-10 and subsequent sugar seasons.

- The cane price announced by the Central Government is decided on the basis of the recommendations of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) in consultation with the State Governments and after taking feedback from associations of sugar industry.
- **State Advised Prices (SAP)** are announced by key sugarcane producing states which are generally higher than FRP.

Reference:

- <https://www.thehindu.com/business/agri-business/sugarcane-fair-and-remunerative-price-hiked-to-290-a-quintal/article36096850.ece>
- https://dfpd.gov.in/gen_policy.htm

- IUCN Status: Least Concern
- Indian Wildlife Protection Act, 1972: Schedule

Threats are Illegal hunting, habitat loss and antipathy toward the species because of its reputation as a man-eater.

Source:

<https://www.downtoearth.org.in/news/wildlife-biodiversity/odisha-s-kendrapara-now-india-s-only-district-to-have-all-3-species-of-crocodilians-78740>

Q.100) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct: Gharial:** It is also known as the gavial or the fish-eating crocodile, It is the longest among all living crocodilians.

Conservation:

- Critically Endangered (IUCN Red List).
- Schedule I: Indian Wildlife Protection Act, 1972.
- Appendix I: CITES.

Threats are Loss of habitat because of sand mining and conversion to agriculture, depletion of fish resources.

- **Pair 2 is incorrect: Mugger Crocodile:** Mugger Crocodile is also called marsh crocodile or broad-snouted crocodile. It is an egg-laying and hole-nesting species. It is native to freshwater habitats from southern Iran and Pakistan to the Indian subcontinent and Sri Lanka.

Conservation:

- IUCN Status: Vulnerable.
- Indian Wildlife Protection Act, 1972: Schedule 1.
- CITES: Appendix I.

- **Pair 3 is incorrect: Saltwater Crocodile:** It is considered as the Earth's largest living crocodile species native to saltwater habitats and brackish wetlands. It is found throughout the east coast of India, Southeast Asia and northern Australia. Bhitarkanika National Park in Odisha houses 70% of India's estuarine crocodiles or saltwater crocodiles.

Conservation: